

Cumulative Final Study Guide

EAM310 · East Asian Medicine Diagnosis I · VUIM Summer 2026

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Full Cumulative · Weeks 1–9, built from lecture transcripts + slides

How to use this guide: This is the deep-dive reference — the reasoning, analogies, and clinical stories behind every table, pulled directly from Schrier's lectures. Read once per week for understanding, then drill the Cram Sheet for speed. Week 5 is intentionally absent (midterm week, no new content). Note: Weeks 7 and 8 topics are drawn from the transcripts that actually contain that content (Inquiry and Palpation respectively), since the raw file names for these two weeks are swapped relative to their actual topics.

1 · Week 1 — Vital Substances

The Vital Substances — Jing, Qi, Blood, Body Fluids, and Shen — are the raw material every later diagnostic system (8 Principles, Zang-Fu, Pulse, Tongue) reads for signs of excess, deficiency, stagnation, or heat. Schrier opens the course with these because you can't correctly name a pattern in Week 2 onward without first knowing what substance is out of balance.

The Three Treasures — Schrier's Candle Analogy

Jing, Qi, and Shen are called the Three Treasures, and the clearest way through them is the candle Schrier uses in lecture: **Jing is the candle itself** — the wax and the wick, the physical foundation. **Qi is the flame** — the energy in action, the process of burning. **Shen is the light the flame gives off** — the least material, the most refined, the actual purpose of the candle. You cannot have a flame without wax to burn, and once the wax is gone the flame goes out — which is why Jing is called the most superior of the three treasures: everything else depends on it. And you can't have light without a flame burning steadily, which is why Shen depends on both Jing and Qi being intact. This ordering (Jing → Qi → Shen, dense to refined) is the same ordering you'll see repeated everywhere in this system: physical substance, powering process, resulting phenomenon.

Treasure	Candle Role	Associated Organ/Element
Jing 精	Wax + wick (foundation)	Kidney, Earth
Qi 氣	The flame (energy in action)	Spleen/Stomach, Humanity
Shen 神	The light given off	Heart, Heaven

Jīng 精 (Essence) — The Bank Account Analogy

Pre-Heaven Essence is best understood as an inheritance: your parents' combined sexual energies at conception give you a fixed starting balance, stored in the Kidneys, that determines your constitutional strength for life. You cannot add to that original balance — once spent, it's gone. Post-Heaven Essence, extracted from food and fluid by the Spleen and Stomach after birth, works like income: it continuously deposits into the same account, topping up what the Pre-Heaven inheritance provided. Kidney Essence is the running balance of both combined.

Type	Source	Nature	Clinical Significance
Pre-Heaven 先天精	Blending of parents' sexual energies before birth	Fixed quantity/quality, cannot be replenished; stored in Kidney	Nourishes embryo/fetus; determines constitutional makeup, strength, vitality
Post-Heaven 後天精	Refined food & fluids after birth (Spleen/Stomach)	Can be stored and replenished	Continuously tops up Kidney Essence — "income" replenishing a fixed inheritance
Kidney Essence 腎精	Pre-Heaven + Post-Heaven combined	Fixed quantity; replenished by Post-Heaven; resides at Mìng Mén	Generates Tiān Guǐ (menses/sperm); produces Marrow → Spinal Cord → Brain

Quick Recall: preserve Pre-Heaven Essence through good work/rest/diet/exercise habits — you can't earn more of it, only spend it slower.

Jing Deficiency Signs	Detail
Children	Poor bone development, soft bones; late fontanelle closure; mental dullness/retardation; developmental delays
Adults	Softening of bones, weak knees/legs, lower backache, loose teeth; poor memory, absent-mindedness; tinnitus, deafness, premature greying; infertility, weakness of sexual activity

Qì 氣 (Vital Force) — What It Actually Means

Schrier is direct about a common complaint: people say Qi is impossible to define because it's "abstract." His counter is that Qi has a very specific set of meanings — the confusion comes from not being specific about which meaning is in play. Depending on context, Qi has been translated as vitality, vital breath, material force, matter-energy, or life force. The six contextual meanings that matter for this course: (1) vitality/energy/gas/air/vapor, (2) vital breath, (3) soul/creative force/inspiration, (4) aura, (5) environmental forces (the Liù Qì: Wind, Cold, Summer-Heat, Dryness, Fire, Dampness), and (6) nature/temperature (the Sì Qì: Hot, Warm, Cool, Cold).

Qi Formation Flow

Air Qi (inhaled by the Lungs) and Food Qi (extracted by Spleen/Stomach from what you eat and drink) combine in the chest to form Zong Qi (Gathering/Ancstral Qi). Zong Qi is the final raw material that becomes Zhen Qi (True Qi), which then splits into its Yin aspect (Ying Qi, nutritive, travels inside the vessels) and its Yang aspect (Wei Qi, defensive, travels outside the vessels). This is the same acupuncture Qi you're engaging when you needle a point.

Name	漢字	Source	Location	Key Functions
Congenital Qi	先天氣	Inherited at conception	Kidneys	Determines constitution; cannot be replenished; composite of Jing Qi & Yuan Qi
Air/Clear Qi	清氣	Inhaled by Lungs	Lungs	Inhalation and respiration
Food/Grain Qi	穀氣	Food → Stomach "rots & ripens" → Spleen transforms	Spleen/ Stomach	Origin of Qi & Blood; rises to chest to combine with Air Qi; Heart transforms into Blood
Gathering Qi	宗氣	Air Qi + Food Qi	Chest (stored)	Nourishes Heart & Lung; controls speech/voice strength; promotes blood circulation to extremities; regulates breathing with Yuan Qi
Source/Original Qi	原氣	Kidney Essence (Pre-Heaven)	Ming Mén; San Jiao	"Motive force" — arouses & moves all organs; conduit for San Jiao; exits at Source Points
True/Vital Qi	真氣	Zong Qi (final stage)	Meridians	Splits into Ying Qi & Wei Qi; this IS Meridian Qi
Nutritive Qi	營氣	Zhen Qi (Yin aspect)	Inside vessels/ channels	Nourishes internal organs; closely linked to Blood; the Qi activated during acupuncture needling
Defensive Qi	衛氣	Zhen Qi (Yang aspect)	Outside vessels; Còu Lǐ	Protects from pathogens; controls pores; moistens skin/hair; warms Zang-Fu; circulates 50×/24h (linked to Lungs)
Central Qi	中氣	Spleen Qi	Middle Jiao	Supports transformation/transportation; raises Qi (prevents prolapse) — "Earth holds everyone in check"
Upright Qi	正氣	Wei Qi + Ying Qi + Kidney Essence	Whole body	Body's total defense; opposite of Xié Qì (pathogenic Qi)

6 Functions of Qi

Schrier frames movement as the core principle behind all six functions: "Life is about movement. If there is proper movement, there is no pain. If there is no movement, there is pain in the body."

Function	Mechanism	Clinical Note
Transporting	Movement in all directions: up/down (ascending/descending), in/out (entering/exiting). Think of Qi as railways moving information, goods, and troops through a city.	No movement = pain
Warming	Function of Yang Qi — all physiological processes depend on warmth	Fluids are Yin and need Yang warmth to transform/transport/excrete; Qi def → Cold signs
Protecting	Primarily Wei Qi, nourishing the Còu Lǐ (space between skin and muscles — the exterior energetic layer)	The Lungs govern the skin, the most exterior part of the body; Wei Qi strength = resistance to Wind/Cold/Damp
Holding	Yang Qi holds Yin substances (Blood, fluids) in their proper place	Deficiency → incontinence, excessive bleeding/sweating — things "leak out"
Transforming	Converts dense matter (food, fluids) into subtler Qi forms	Qi def → Phlegm & Dampness accumulation
Rising	Holds body structures in proper anatomical position; primary organ is Spleen (Zhōng Qì)	Qi def → sinking → organ prolapse (uterus, rectum, stomach); distinct from Holding (which is anti-leak, not anti-sink)

Qi Pathologies — 4 Patterns

Pattern	Mechanism & Cause	Signs & Symptoms	Tongue/Pulse
Qi Deficiency	More Qi consumed than produced. Affects Lung, Spleen, Kidney, Heart. Causes: illness, overwork, poor diet, lack of sleep, excessive exercise.	Fatigue (key symptom, both physical and mental), slight SOB, weak voice, spontaneous sweating, poor appetite, loose stools	Empty pulse; pale/normal tongue
Sinking Qi	Aspect of Qi Deficiency — insufficient Yang Qi to rise and ascend. Primary organ: Spleen.	All Qi Def signs plus: feeling of bearing down, mental depression, listlessness, organ prolapse	Empty pulse
Qi Stagnation	Often Liver, also Lungs/Heart/Stomach/Spleen/Intestines. Causes: emotional stress, irregular eating, excessive work.	Distension (subjective/objective) — more distension than pain — moving/distending pain, mental depression, irritability, frequent sighing, mood swings	Wiry pulse; tongue normal or slightly red on sides
Rebellious Qi	Qi moves in the wrong direction for that organ (Maciocia Table 31.1)	Stomach should descend — ascending=belching/nausea/vomiting. Spleen should ascend — descending=diarrhea/prolapse. Liver excessive ascent=headache/dizziness/irritability; excessive horizontal=nausea/belching (invading Stomach) or diarrhea (invading Spleen). Lung/Kidney should descend — ascending=cough/asthma. Heart should descend — ascending=restlessness/insomnia.	Varies by organ

Clinical judgment call from lecture: when a patient says "I'm depressed," Schrier stresses you can't stop there — "mental depression" appears in both Sinking Qi and Qi Stagnation patterns. You have to unpack what the depression actually feels like (heavy/listless = more Sinking; irritable/gloomy with mood swings = more Stagnation) before you can commit to a pattern.

Xuè 血 (Blood)

Blood in East Asian Medicine is not the Western hematological fluid — it's described as a very dense, material form of Qi, the most Yin of the vital substances. Sū Wèn 26 states "Blood is the mind of a person," and Líng Shū 32 adds that "when Blood is harmonized, the mind is calm in its residence." Schrier frames the Yin-Yang split along gender lines as a teaching heuristic: men tend to be more ruled by Qi, women more by Blood — which is also why Blood patterns show up so prominently in gynecological presentations (menstruation, Tiān Guǐ).

Source Organ	Role in Blood Formation
Spleen	Main source — generates Blood from Gǔ Qì (Food Qi)
Lung	Pushes Gǔ Qì toward the Heart for transformation
Heart	Transforms Gǔ Qì into Blood
Kidney	Makes Blood via Marrow and Kidney Essence

#	Function of Blood
1	Nourishes all tissues and organs
2	Circulates with Yīng Qì (inseparable)
3	Moistens body, skin, sinews, eyes
4	Houses the Shen — anchors the Mind; Blood deficiency → insomnia, anxiety
5	Determines Menstruation (via Tiān Guǐ)

Quick Recall: the three organs most closely engaged with Blood are Heart (governs circulation), Spleen (makes it, keeps it in the vessels), and Liver (stores it, nourishes sinews, moistens eyes, regulates menstruation).

Blood Pathologies — 4 Patterns

Pattern	Mechanism	Signs & Symptoms	Tongue/Pulse
Blood Deficiency	Fails to nourish/moisten; fails to anchor Shen. Causes: inadequate blood-rich foods, deficiency in blood-producing organs, blood loss, consumption by excessive mental/physical activity.	Dull-white sallow complexion, pale lips, dizziness, poor memory, numbness/tingling, blurred vision, insomnia, scanty periods/amenorrhea, depression, slight anxiety	Pale, thin, slightly dry tongue; Choppy or Fine pulse
Blood Stasis	Potentially serious — linked to cancer, fibroids, endometriosis, heart disease, stroke. Causes: Qi stagnation (most common — "Blood is the mother of Qi, so if Qi stagnates, Blood stagnates"), Qi deficiency, Heat in Blood, Blood deficiency, Interior Cold, Emotions, Diet, Trauma.	Stabbing, fixed, or boring pain; dark complexion; purple lips and nails; dark blood with dark clots; fixed abdominal masses	Purple tongue (location varies); Wiry, Choppy, or Firm pulse
Heat in Blood	Invasion of Heat to the Yin/Blood level, OR excess internal heat in Liver/Heart	Feeling of heat, skin diseases with red eruptions, thirst, bleeding. Heart→anxiety/mouth ulcers; Liver→skin itching/redness; Uterus→excessive blood loss; Intestines→blood in stools	Red tongue; Rapid pulse
Loss of Blood	Cause 1: Qi Deficiency → cannot hold Blood (deficiency pattern). Cause 2: Blood Heat → pushes Blood out (excess pattern). Less common: Blood Stasis, Yin Deficiency.	Bloody nose (Lung), vomiting blood (Stomach), coughing blood (Lung), blood in stool (Large Intestine), menorrhagia/metrorrhagia (Liver/Uterus), blood in urine (Bladder)	Pale tongue; Fine/Choppy pulse

Schrier offers two memorable images for the mechanisms behind Blood Stasis: Interior Cold congealing Blood is like putting liquid in a freezer — it makes ice. Heat condensing Blood is like heating an instant gravy packet on the stove: keep the heat on and keep stirring, and eventually it thickens into a brick if you leave it too long.

Qi Stagnation vs Blood Stasis — Key Differentiator (Maciocia Table 32.2)

	Qi Stagnation	Blood Stasis
Pain vs distension	More distension than pain; moving	More pain than distension; fixed
Pain character	Distending, comes & goes with emotional state	Boring or stabbing, constant
Abdominal masses	Appear and disappear	Fixed
Skin	Not visible on skin	Purple blotches or bruises
Tongue	Normal or slightly red on sides	Purple on sides (or location-specific — see below)
Pulse	Wiry	Wiry, Firm, or Choppy

Blood Stasis — Signs by Location

Schrier's teaching device for remembering how Blood Stasis spreads to a paired organ: think of a messy roommate. The mess is contained in their room at first, but over time the smell lingers into the shared space, and eventually the whole apartment is affected. Similarly, Stomach Blood Stasis can show resonance in the Large Intestine (its paired Yang Ming organ) because "when one thing happens to one, you might see similar resonances in its paired organ."

Location	Key Signs
Liver	Purple nails (Liver manifests on nails); dark face; painful periods with dark clots; abdominal & premenstrual pain; purple tongue on the sides; wiry/firm pulse
Heart	Purple lips; stabbing/pricking chest pain; mental restlessness (Shen disturbance); purple tongue toward the front (chest region); distended sub-lingual veins; choppy/knotted pulse
Lung (Upper Burner)	Chest oppression; coughing dark blood; tongue purple on sides toward the front
Stomach (Middle Burner)	Epigastric pain; vomiting dark blood; tongue purple in the center (Stomach's tongue zone)
Intestines/Uterus (Lower Burner)	Dark blood in stools; severe abdominal pain; painful periods with dark clots; amenorrhea; fixed abdominal masses; wiry/firm pulse

Jīn Yè 津液 (Body Fluids)

Fluids originate from food and drink and are separated by the Spleen into clean and turbid. Clean fluids rise to the Lungs and spread to the skin, then descend to the Kidneys. Turbid fluids go to the Small Intestine for a further round of separation — pure fluids continue to the Bladder (becoming sweat via the exterior), impure fluids continue to the Large Intestine (becoming urine via the downward path). Schrier's point here is philosophical as much as clinical: "even within the turbid, there is a clear; within the clear, there is a turbid" — Yin and Yang are infinitely divisible, so even the "impure" fraction sent toward the Large Intestine still separates further into its own pure/impure gradient.

	Jīn 津 (Yang)	Yè 液 (Yin)
Character	Clear, light, thin, watery	Heavy, dense, turbid
Circulates with	Wei Qi, on the Exterior (between skin/muscles)	Ying Qi, in the Interior
Movement	Quick	Slow
Controlled by	Lung (Upper Burner)	Spleen & Kidney (Middle/Lower Burner)
Moistens	Skin & muscles — manifests as sweat, tears, saliva, mucus; becomes part of Blood	Joints, spine, brain, bone marrow; lubricates orifices (eyes, ears, nose, mouth)

Quick Recall (mnemonic from lecture): "Jin" like gin the drink — clear and thin. Fluid Deficiency is Yin in nature, so deficiency always presents as dryness.

Edema and Phlegm — Reading the Fluids Excess Side

Excess fluid patterns (edema, phlegm) mirror the deficiency patterns above but in reverse. Pitting edema (finger leaves a dip that takes time to disappear) is a Yang deficiency of Spleen, Lung, and/or Kidney — the Yang can't mobilize fluids so they pool. The location where edema starts is diagnostic: starting in the face/hands and spreading = Lung Yang deficiency; starting in the abdomen spreading to the limbs = Spleen Yang; starting in the legs/ankles = Kidney Yang. Non-pitting edema points instead to Qi stagnation or Dampness.

Phlegm Type	Presentation
Damp-Phlegm	Profuse sticky white phlegm, chest/epigastric oppression, nausea, sticky taste, no thirst; swollen tongue w/ sticky coat; slippery pulse
Phlegm-Heat	Sticky yellow phlegm, chest oppression, red face, dry mouth, restlessness; red swollen tongue w/ sticky yellow coat; rapid slippery pulse
Cold-Phlegm	White watery phlegm, chest oppression, cold limbs, nausea; pale swollen tongue w/ white wet coat; deep slow slippery pulse
Wind-Phlegm	Dizziness, nausea, vomiting, numbness (esp. unilateral), coughing phlegm, rattling throat sound, aphasia; swollen deviated tongue; wiry pulse

Substantial phlegm (the sputum you can see and cough up) is distinct from non-substantial phlegm, which is retained subcutaneously or in the channels — this is the phlegm that can obstruct the Heart orifice and block the Shen, or settle in joints causing arthritic deformities, or in the Gallbladder/Kidneys as stones.

Shén 神 (Spirit) — Healthy vs. Deranged

Returning to the candle: you can hold the wax (Jing) and even touch the flame (Qi, though Schrier doesn't recommend it), but you cannot grasp the light itself. Shen is the least material of the Three Treasures, and describes the whole mental, emotional, and spiritual aspect of a person — not just "spirit" in a narrow sense.

Observation	Having Shen	Loss of Shen	False Shen
Complexion	Bright and moist	Dim, dull sheen	Dull, then suddenly lustrous
Eyes	Alert, vivid, twinkle	Dull, blurred vision	Dull, then suddenly bright
Mind/Speech	Clear speech, agile	Confused, incoherent	Unclear, then sudden change
Respiration	Smooth, even	Uneven, shallow, SOB	Feeble, then briefly steady

False Shen is a warning, not a recovery: a chronically ill, exhausted patient can suddenly perk up — alert eyes, strong clear speech — and then pass away shortly after. This is a sudden floating-up of Yang Qi as Yin and Yang begin to separate at the end of life, not genuine improvement.

Deranged Shen Patterns

Term	Presentation
Fán zào	Irritability with hot/feverish sensation; may drive the patient to prefer nudity or jump into water
Zàng zào (Lily disease pattern)	Mental depression, hallucination, disorientation, frequent crying spells, bouts of yawning
Bǎi hé bìng	Chronic depression, apathy, aversion to speaking/mumbling to self, insomnia, anorexia, sleepwalking
Diān (Yin madness)	Chronic depression, aversion to speaking or mumbling to self, inappropriate laughing/crying
Kuáng (Yang madness)	Raving with obscenities, restlessness, singing loudly in high places, wandering naked, aggression

The Five Spirits (Wu Shen) — One per Zang Organ

Organ	Spirit	Domain	Imbalance Signs	Outer BL Point
Heart	Shén (small-s)	Consciousness, insight, awareness, compassion; aligns one to the world and allows communication; reflected in the brightness of the eyes	Mania, lack of inspiration, scattered spirit, insomnia, hysteria, sadness, depression	Mind Hall (outer BL, across from Heart Back-Shu) — anxiety, insomnia, depression
Liver	Hún 魂	Vision, imagination, direction, benevolence; the "soul" that enters at birth and continues after death; repository of dreams, plans, aspirations	Delusions, hallucinations, psychosis, nightmares, sleepwalking/talking, anger, frustration, jealousy, apathy, paranoia	Gate of the Ethereal Soul — roots and steadies the Hun, aids capacity for life planning
Lung	Pò 魄	Animal wit, embodiment, bodily sensation; dies when the body stops functioning; gives instinctive reactions and the ability to feel sensations	Emotional numbness, mind-body disconnect, overindulgence, obsession with beauty/vanity, sadness, grief, inability to let go	Gate of the Corporeal Soul — soothes spirit, nourishes Qi, aids letting go of prolonged grief
Spleen	Yì 意	Integrity, intention, clear thought, devotion; ability to think clearly, study, and manifest ideas; "standing on firm ground"	Poor concentration, lack of expression, overthinking/worrying, stuck thought patterns, lack of sympathy or over-smothering	BL 49 — tonifies mental aspects of Spleen: memory, concentration, study capacity
Kidney	Zhì 志	Willpower, courage, drive, survival instinct; the fundamental push and determination to be alive	Lack of willpower/drive, no life goals, depression, fearfulness, low self-esteem	BL 52 — strengthens willpower and determination

Substance Relationships — Statements of Fact

Relationship
Qi is the commander of Blood; Blood is the mother of Qi.
Blood nourishes Body Fluids; Body Fluids replenish Blood.
Qi transforms, transports, and holds Body Fluids; Body Fluids help nourish Qi.
Liver Blood nourishes Essence; Kidney Essence transforms into Blood.

Body Fluids Deficiency by Organ

Organ	Signs
Lung	Dry skin, dry cough
Stomach	Dry mouth/lips/tongue, thirst with desire to sip small amounts (not gulp)
Kidney	Scanty urination, dry mouth at night, dry throat

Non-Substantial Phlegm — Full Sub-Types

Type	Presentation
Qi Phlegm	Feeling of swelling in the throat (no actual swelling, "plum-pit"), difficulty swallowing, oppression of chest/diaphragm, irritability, moodiness, depression; Wiry pulse
Under the skin	Lumps under the skin, nerve ganglia swellings, lymph node swelling, thyroid swelling, lipoma
In the channels	Numbness
Misting the Heart	Mental illness
Gallbladder and Kidneys	Stones
In the joints	Bone deformities in chronic rheumatoid arthritis

Quick Recall: Spleen deficiency is the main cause of Phlegm formation; Lung failing to diffuse/lower fluids and Kidney failing to transform/excrete fluids both contribute.

Dietary Therapy by Pattern (Reference)

Not a complete list — many foods overlap categories. Included for reference since Schrier's slides pair each Vital Substance pattern with supportive foods.

Pattern	Example Foods
Qi Deficiency	Rice, beef, chicken, sweet potato, carrots, beans, dates, mushroom, oat, quinoa, tofu
Qi Stagnation	Basil, cardamom, chive, fennel, turnip, dark leafy greens, peach, squash
Blood Deficiency	Beets, beef, bone marrow, chicken, eggs, dates, kale, spinach, aduki beans, dandelion, liver, mussels, sardines
Blood Stagnation	Chicken, eggs, eggplant, onion, scallion
Phlegm	Almonds, apple, daikon, garlic, mushroom, mustard leaf/seed, onions, radish
Jing/Essence Deficiency	Almonds, bone marrow, chicken, egg, kidney, liver, bee pollen

Vegetarianism note (Schrier's clinical aside): vegetarian diets are fine long-term if managed well — China and India have the world's longest vegetarian traditions. Risk arises only if a patient doesn't supplement adequately: support Blood with blue-green algae and dark leafy greens; support Jing/Essence (Blood's foundation) with nuts and seeds; avoid overly pungent foods (they weaken Blood via sweating/Qi movement) and foods that are hard to digest (they weaken the digestive system itself).

2 · Week 2 — Eight Principles 八綱

Ba Gang Bian Zheng is the foundation for every other pattern-differentiation method. It's rooted in the Su Wen and Shang Han Lun, though the specific "Eight Principles" term dates to the Qing dynasty, based on (but greatly simplified from) Zhang Jingyue's Jingyue Quanshu.

Why Pattern, Not Cause, Comes First

Schrier's standing answer when a student asks "what's the best point for lupus?" is "I don't know what lupus is — what's your TCM diagnosis?" One Western disease can result from several different patterns, and one pattern can present as several different Western diseases. Differentiating Interior/Exterior is NOT based on what caused the disharmony (etiology) — it's based on the location of the disease.

Exterior Conditions

Concept	Detail
Location	Skin, hair, muscles, interspaces between muscles, superficial Luo (collateral) channels
Nature	Sudden onset, short duration, early stage of an exogenous disease
Type 1	Affects skin/muscles, acute onset, caused by exterior pathogen (e.g. Wind-Cold, Wind-Heat invasion)
Type 2	Affects the channels, slower onset (e.g. Bi Syndrome/Painful Obstruction) — obstruction of Qi circulation in channels/joints by Cold, Dampness, Wind, or Heat

Exterior Pattern Variant	Manifestation
Main clinical picture	Aversion to cold, fever, aching body, stiff neck, Floating pulse
A. Exterior Cold, deficient type	Slight fever, pronounced aversion to cold, severe body aches, severe stiff neck, no sweating, no thirst, Floating-Tight pulse, thin white coating
C/D. Exterior Excess vs Exterior Deficiency	Distinguished mainly by presence/absence of sweating and pulse strength (Excess = no sweat, stronger pulse; Deficiency = some sweat, weaker/Floating-Slow pulse)

Exterior Treatment Principle	Detail
Strategy	Expel the pathogen, disperse it, keep the evil from moving further inside
Acupuncture	Open the meridians, expel pathogens; points on the head, arm, upper back (Yang areas); cupping on shoulder/upper back to expel
Herbs	Leaves and twigs (the "ends" of the plant) — e.g. jin yin hua, bo he, fang feng, xin yi hua. Light herbs disperse disease at the superficial level.

Interior Conditions

Concept	Detail
Location	The five Zang and six Fu organs
Key marker of the shift	Disappearance of aversion to cold + onset of feeling of heat / aversion to heat
Two pathways to Interior	(1) Transmission of an exogenous pathogen from Exterior to Interior; (2) Functional disturbance of Zang-Fu organs directly, with no Exterior stage at all (e.g. emotional stress, diet)
Nature	Chronic, longer duration, mid-or-late stage of disease

Differentiator	Exterior	Interior
Fever	Fever + aversion to cold together	Fever with NO aversion to cold, or fever absent entirely
Tongue	Thin coating	Coating thicker; color reflects the pattern (yellow=Heat, etc.)
Pulse	Floating	Deep

Relationship between Exterior and Interior: pathogens transmitted from Exterior to Interior indicate hyperactivity of the pathogen and/or weakened resistance — incorrect treatment, delayed treatment, or an inherently strong pathogen can all drive this progression. Example: illness starts with slight fever, aversion to cold, Floating pulse — then progresses to high fever, no aversion to cold, deeper pulse as the pathogen moves inward.

Cold Patterns

Manifestation	
Aversion to cold, preference for warmth, tastelessness, pallor, cold limbs, watery discharge, pale tongue with white coating, Slow or Tense pulse	
Type	Treatment
Exterior Cold (common cold-type)	Warm and dispel Cold; Reducing method of acupuncture
Deficient Cold	Warm the body; Reinforcing method, warming needle and moxibustion

Heat Patterns

Manifestation
Fever, thirst with preference for cold drinks, redness of face/eyes, irritability, constipation, dark yellow/scanty urine, red tongue, Rapid pulse
Deficient Heat caveat: in a Deficiency pattern, all these Heat signs will be Milder since the underlying Yin, Yang, Qi, and Blood are already depleted — a full-blown "raging" Heat picture points toward Excess, not Deficiency.

Hot vs Cold	Cold	Heat
Pulse	Slow/Tight	Fast/Rapid

Relationship & Combinations Between Hot and Cold

Transformation	Example
Cold transforms to Heat	Exterior Cold produces fever/aversion to cold/aches/no sweat — then aversion to cold subsides, fever persists, irritability/thirst/yellow tongue appear
Heat transforms to Cold	High fever, profuse sweating — then abrupt cold limbs, pallor, Deep-Slow pulse (a dangerous collapse pattern)
Combined Pattern	Signs & Symptoms
Cold on Exterior + Heat in Interior	Pre-existing Interior Heat then invaded by exterior Wind-Cold: fever with aversion to cold, no sweating, headache, stiff neck, body aches (Exterior Cold) + irritability and thirst (Interior Heat)
Heat on Exterior + Cold in Interior	Pre-existing Cold condition then attacked by exterior Wind-Heat: fever with aversion to cold, sore throat, thirst, headache, Floating-Rapid pulse + loose stools, chilliness, profuse pale urine
Heat above, Cold below	Heat rises while Cold sinks: thirst, irritability, sour regurgitation, bitter taste, mouth ulcers (Heat above) + loose stools, borborygmi, profuse pale urine (Cold below)
Combination Heat + Cold (mixed, not layered)	Extremely common in practice — e.g. Kidney-Yang Deficiency with Damp-Heat in the Bladder, or Spleen-Yang Deficiency with Liver-Fire

False Heat/True Cold & False Cold/True Heat

Not the same as Empty-Heat/Empty-Cold. Those arise from genuine Yin or Yang deficiency — the Heat or Cold is real, just from a deficiency mechanism. In False Heat/False Cold, the surface appearance is genuinely false: what you see does not match what's actually happening internally.

Exam Method	False Heat / True Cold	False Cold / True Heat
Observation	Red cheeks but color is "like powder" (superficial, floating); listless, desires to lie curled up; pale and wet tongue	Dark face, bright eyes with spirit, red-dry lips; irritability, strong body; red-dry tongue body
Hearing	Quiet, low voice	Heavy breathing, loud voice
Interrogation	Thirst but no desire to drink, or desires warm fluids; body feels hot but likes to be covered; sore throat without redness/swelling	Thirst with desire for cold fluids; scanty dark urine; constipation; burning sensation in the anus
Palpation	Pulse Rapid, Floating, Big — but Empty	Pulse Deep, Full; cold limbs but chest and abdomen hot

Quick Recall: in both False patterns, trust palpation and interrogation over the first visual impression — the surface presentation is specifically designed to mislead in these patterns.

Full/Excess vs Empty/Deficient

Concept	Detail
Full/Excess	Not an excess of Zheng Qi (upright/righteous Qi) – rather, the presence of a pathogenic factor disturbing the balance. Manifests acutely and intensely.
Empty/Deficient	A deficiency of Zheng Qi – including deficiency of Qi and Blood. Manifestations are much milder than a Full condition.
Pain comparison	Full = severe, intense pain. Empty = more of an ache than a sharp pain.

Exterior Manifestation	Full	Empty
Fever/sweating	Fever, no sweating	Slight or no fever, sweating present
Aversion	Aversion to cold	Aversion to wind
Body aches	Severe	Slight
Pulse	Floating-Tight	Floating-Slow

Full Heat vs Empty Heat

	Full-Heat (Excess Yang)	Empty-Heat (Yin Deficiency)
Mechanism	External (Wind-Heat) or internal Excess Yang	Yin deficient long enough that Yang becomes relatively Excess
Signs	Thirst, feeling of heat, mental restlessness, red face, dry stools, scanty dark urine	Feeling of heat in afternoon/evening, dry mouth desiring small sips, five-palm heat, night sweats, malar flush
Pulse/Tongue	Rapid-Full; Red tongue with yellow coating	Rapid pulse (Empty type); Red tongue WITHOUT coating
Etiology	Emotional problems, diet (red meat/spices/alcohol), external pathogen transformed into Heat	Overwork, irregular eating, excessive sexual activity, persistent heavy blood loss

Full Cold vs Empty Cold (Table 30.2)

	Full-Cold (Excess Yin)	Empty-Cold (Yang Deficiency)
Face	Bright-white	Dull-white
Pain	Sharp, worse on pressure	Dull, better on pressure
Bowels	Constipation	Loose stools
Pulse	Full-Tight-Deep	Weak-Slow-Deep
Tongue	Thick white coating	Thin white coating
Etiology	Cold foods, external Cold penetrating directly	Diet, excessive sexual activity, internal Cold injuring Yang

Excess/Deficiency of Yin and Yang – Full Mechanisms

Pattern	Mechanism	Symptoms
Excess of Yang (Full-Heat)	Excess Heat consumes Body Fluids → Dryness/Heat. Three types: (1) external pathogen (Wind-Heat, Summer-Heat); (2) internally generated (emotional stress/diet → Heart-Fire, Liver-Fire); (3) transformation of another pathogen, even Cold (e.g. Wind-Cold turning into interior Heat)	Restlessness, headache, irritability, pain worse with pressure, red tongue, Full pulse
Excess of Yin (Full-Cold)	Excess Cold consumes Yang. External Yin pathogen (Wind-Cold, Cold-Damp); Cold invading directly to Interior (Stomach/Intestines/Uterus) bypassing Exterior stage; Cold invading channels/joints (Bi Syndrome)	Cold limbs, weakness, contracture, pain improved with heat, pale tongue, Slow pulse
Deficiency of Yang (Empty-Cold)	Yang spontaneously deficient, apparent excess of Yin results. Causes: dietary (excess cold food), excessive physical/sexual activity, internally generated Dampness, or from Full-Cold over time	Signs of Cold but arising from deficiency: fatigue, weakness, pain improves with heat AND pressure, pale tongue, Slow-Weak pulse
Deficiency of Yin (Empty-Heat)	Yin depleted, apparent excess of Yang results, consuming Body Fluids. May be caused by Full-Heat over time	Yin deficiency signs: dryness (mouth in afternoon, skin, eyes) + mild specific Heat: night sweats, five-palm heat, insomnia, red tongue, thin Rapid pulse

Collapse of Yin & Yang – Critical Prognostic Patterns

Collapse indicates an extremely severe, sudden state of Emptiness – a complete separation of Yin and Yang. Often, though not necessarily, followed by death. Recognizing these patterns matters clinically far more than any quiz question.

Collapse Type	Manifestations
Collapse of Yang	Chilliness, cold limbs, weak breathing, profuse oily sweating, no thirst, frequent/profuse urination or incontinence, loose stools or incontinence, Minute-Deep pulse, Pale-Wet-Swollen-Short tongue
Collapse of Yin	Abundant perspiration, skin hot to touch, hot limbs, dry mouth with desire for cold liquids in small sips, retention of urine, constipation, Floating-Empty-Rapid pulse, Red-Peeled-Short-Dry tongue

Note: Collapse of Yang and Collapse of Yin look almost like opposite mirror images of each other (cold/wet vs hot/dry) – both represent Yin and Yang losing their mutual rootedness, just from opposite directions.

Yin/Yang – The Master Pair

Schrier ties Yin/Yang back to Blood and Qi: Yang is energy (Qi), Yin is fluid (Blood). As a teaching heuristic, men tend to be more Qi/Yang-ruled, women more Blood/Yin-ruled – part of why gynecological patterns lean so heavily on Blood pathology.

Pair	Key Differentiator
Yin/Yang	Master pair. Yin = Interior+Cold+Deficiency (slower, quieter). Yang = Exterior+Heat+Excess (faster, louder, active).

Shao Yang – the "Katy Perry / Hokey Pokey" pattern: Schrier's mnemonic for the half-Exterior, half-Interior stage between Tai Yang and Yang Ming: the patient is "hot and cold, yes and no" – in and out, like the hokey pokey or Katy Perry's "Hot N Cold." A bridge concept toward the Six Conformations built on top of the 8 Principles.

Critical Thinking Modes in Pattern Differentiation

Mode	How It Works
Deductive	From presenting signs/symptoms to a general pattern (fever+aversion to cold+stiff neck+Floating pulse → likely Exterior)
Inductive	General conclusions from historical/typical cases – useful, but not always true; always check the accompanying signs
Analogical	Reasoning by known mechanism-relationships (Heat is known to generate Wind over time → long-term internal Heat predicts eventual internal Wind)

3 · Week 3 — Pulse Diagnosis 脉診

The character 脉 (mài) combines the flesh radical with a component suggesting something long, perpetual, and always-present. Schrier draws out the moon connection: blood is liquid, the moon governs tides, and menstruation has its own lunar rhythm — the pulse is a mirror that lets us observe Yin and Yang directly, since its shape changes and possesses all the essential Yin and Yang.

Handling Subjectivity Honestly

Schrier is upfront that pulse diagnosis is extremely subjective — he, his practice partner, and their supervisor once all felt different things on the same patient. State changes the pulse: a patient who ran up the stairs to their appointment shows a temporarily Rapid pulse reflecting exertion, not Heat. The Ling Shu's fix is presence: "shut the door and close the windows and attune yourself directly with your patient." Schrier's fishing analogy: if you can't find a quality right away, stay patient — shaking the line doesn't make the fish bite any faster.

Six Positions — Two Systems

Position	Left Hand	Right Hand
Cun (superficial), 1st	Hand Shaoyin/HT (Nan Jing) · HT (Bin Hu)	Hand Taiyin/LU (Nan Jing) · LU (Bin Hu)
Guan (middle), 2nd	Foot Jueyin/LR (Nan Jing) · LR (Bin Hu)	Foot Taiyin/SP (Nan Jing) · SP (Bin Hu)
Chi (deep), 3rd	Foot Shaoyin/KI (Nan Jing) · KI (Bin Hu)	Hand Jueyin/PC (Nan Jing) · KI/Ming Men (Bin Hu)

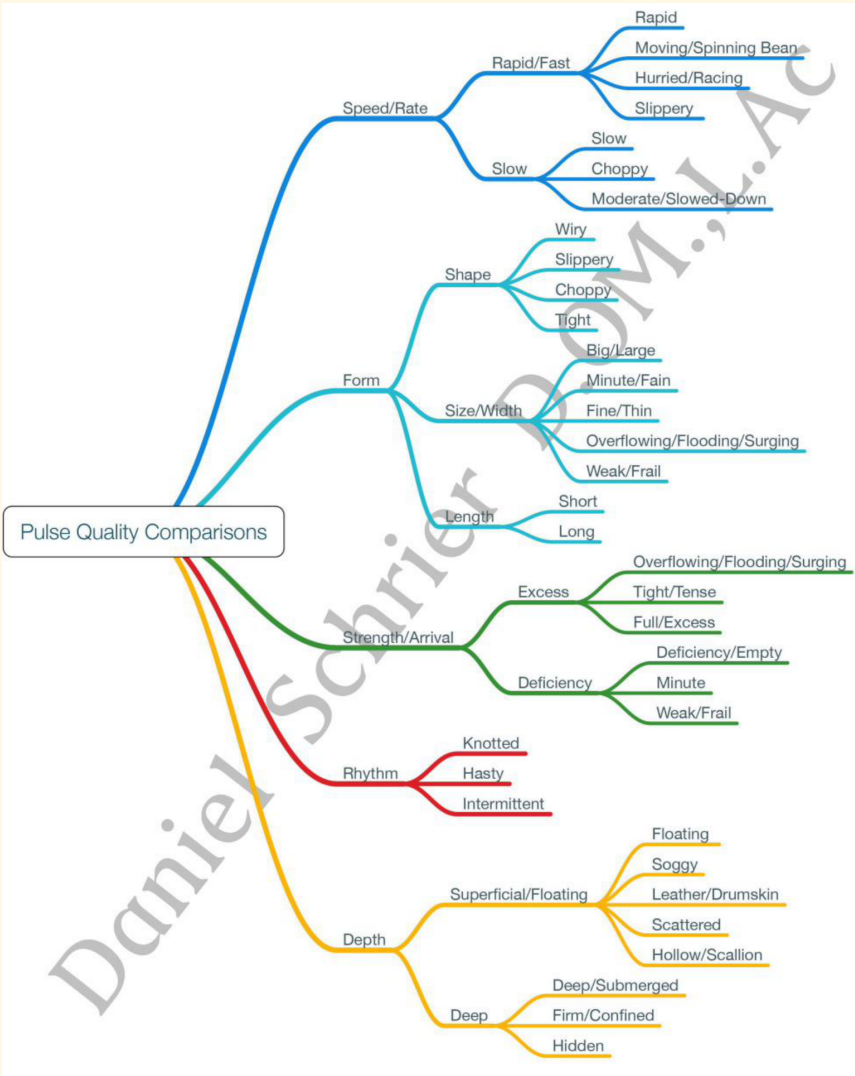
Two valid systems, not a contradiction: the Nan Jing pairs each Zang with a Fu (Cun also carries Hand Taiyang/SI on the left and Hand Yangming/LI on the right; Guan also carries Foot Shaoyang/GB on the left and Foot Yangming/ST on the right; Chi also carries Foot Taiyang/BL on the left and Hand Shaoyang/TH on the right). Bin Hu Mai Xue (Li Shizhen's system) uses a simpler Zang-only mapping, with Right Chi as Kidney/Ming Men directly rather than Pericardium/San Jiao. Know which system a source uses before assuming a discrepancy is an error.

Components of a Normal Pulse

Quality	Detail
Stomach-Qi	Relatively soft, calm, gentle
Spirit	Regular, soft rhythm
Root	Clearly felt on the deep level and at the third (Chi) position

8 Components	Definition
Width	Diameter of the vessel, dependent on Qi and Blood; normal = neither too thin nor too wide
Depth	Location felt strongest; normal = middle depth, showing Qi/Blood flow freely from interior to exterior
Rate	Beats per minute; normal = 4–5 beats/breath, 60–90bpm; reflects state of Yang
Rhythm	Pattern of beats; normal = regular, related to Heart-Qi commanding Blood through the vessels
Strength	Beating force under the finger; normal = moderate, gentle and soft
Length	Relation to the three positions; normal = felt at all positions, neither long nor short; Qi-dependent
Tension	Tautness of the vessel; normal = neither taut nor slack; reflects Qi/Blood condition
Shape	Wave/contour as Blood flows; normal = ascending and descending phases roughly equal

Pulse Quality Comparisons — Organizing Map



Pulse Quality Comparisons mind-map — Prof. Schrier's Week 3 slides.

All 28 Pulse Qualities — Full Detail with Combinations

Schrier's teaching device: build a mental image for each quality the way you'd recognize a person's face. Below: the tactile image, base indication, and the full set of two-quality combinations presented in lecture — the combinations are where exam questions actually live, not just the base quality alone.

Quality	Tactile Image	Base Indication	Key Combinations
Floating 浮	Wood floating on water; wind across a bird's back	Exterior Wind invasion; Yin Deficiency (interior)	Weak=External-Empty · Empty=Summer-Heat or Yin Deficiency · Slippery=Wind-Damp or Wind-Phlegm
Deep/Submerged 沉	A stone thrown into a well, sinking to the bottom	Interior pathogen (Full); Yang Deficiency (Weak)	Wiry=Blood Stasis or Chong Mai issue · Wiry-Slow=Blood stasis from Cold · Slow=Interior Cold · Rapid=Interior Heat · Soggy-Slow=Interior Dampness
Slow 遲	<3 beats/breath, ~40–60bpm	Cold pattern	Floating=Ext Wind-Cold · Deep=Int Cold · Slippery=Cold-Phlegm/Damp-Cold · Choppy=Blood def + Int Cold · Weak=Empty-Cold w/ Yang def · Full=Int Cold, chronic/painful · Wiry=Cold stagnation in Liver channel
Rapid 數	>5 beats/breath, 90–140bpm	Heat pattern	Full=Full-Heat · Empty/Floating-Empty=Empty-Heat · Floating=Ext Wind-Heat · Deep=Int Heat · Overflowing=Full-Heat · Wiry=Liver-Fire · Slippery=Phlegm-Heat
Empty 虛	Wide but forceless at all positions/pressures; sense of emptiness	Qi Deficiency	(base combinations covered under other qualities' "Empty" entries)
Full 實	Felt at all 3 positions and all 3 depths	Full/Excess pattern	Rapid=Full-Heat · Slow=Full-Cold · Tight=Full-Cold · Long=Heat · Wiry=Full Liver pattern
Slippery 滑	A pearl rolling on a plate; oily to the touch	Phlegm, Dampness, food retention, pregnancy	Floating=Wind-Damp/Wind-Phlegm · Rapid=Damp-Heat/Phlegm-Heat · Slow=Damp-Cold/Cold-Phlegm · Big=Phlegm-Heat, Heat predominant · Short/Weak=Damp or Phlegm w/ Qi deficiency
Choppy 澀	Scraping bamboo with a small knife; rough, uneven	Blood Deficiency; exhaustion of Body Fluids	Weak=Depletion of Qi+Blood · Minute=Extreme Blood def · Soggy=Qi/Blood def w/ Dampness · Floating=Ext Wind invasion · Deep=Longstanding Blood def · Full=Blood stasis (potential) · Knotted=Blood stasis from Yang def + Int Cold
Long 長	Smooth and straight, extends beyond normal position	Heat pattern	Rapid/Deep=Internal Heat · Floating=Ext Wind-Heat · Wiry=Liver disharmony (usually excess) · Slippery=Phlegm-Heat · Overflowing=Excess Yang and Heat
Short 短	Cannot be felt in all 3 positions	Severe Qi Deficiency; Stomach-Qi Deficiency	Floating=Lung-Qi def · Choppy=Heart-Qi def · Rapid=Severe Heart-Blood def w/ Empty-Heat · Slow=Yang def w/ Int Cold
Overflowing/Flooding 洪	Ocean waves — come strongly, leave calmly	Full-Heat	Floating=Wind-Heat w/ intense Heat, can progress to Qi level · Deep=Internal Heat · Slippery=Phlegm-Heat, Heat predominant · Soft=Yin def w/ exhaustion of Fluids/Empty-Heat · Tight=Painful Obstruction Syndrome
Fine/Thin 細	Angel-hair pasta — thin but distinct	Blood Deficiency; Dampness w/ severe Qi def	Rapid=Yin def w/ Empty-Heat · Wiry=Liver-Qi stagnation · Tight=Empty-Cold w/ underlying Blood def · Choppy=Severe Blood/Essence def · Weak=Severe Blood def
Minute/Faint 微	Now you feel it, now you don't	Severe deficiency of Qi and Blood	Rapid=Yin def w/ Empty-Heat · Slow=Severe Qi/Blood def w/ Int Cold · Choppy=Exhaustion of Blood · Soggy=Qi/Blood def w/ Dampness · Wiry=Liver-Yang rising w/ underlying Blood def
Tight 緊	A twisted cord snapping back and forth	Cold; Pain	Floating=Ext Wind-Cold, Cold predominant · Deep=Int Full-Cold · Weak-Deep=Int Empty-Cold · Choppy=Cold Bi Syndrome · Slippery=Cold-Phlegm · Firm=Blood stasis from Cold
Wiry 弦	A guitar string about to snap	Liver disharmony; Pain; Phlegm	Rapid=Liver-Fire · Slow=Cold stagnation in Liver channel · Long=Liver-Qi Stagnation or Liver-Blood Stasis · Tight=Blood stasis · Big=Liver-Fire or Liver-Yang rising · Overflowing=Liver-Fire
Slowed-Down/Moderate 緩	4 beats/breath — faster than Slow	Generally healthy — the one normal entry	Soggy=Dampness w/ Spleen-Qi def · Slippery=Cold-Dampness · Fine=Qi/Blood def · Floating=Weakness of Wei Qi · Deep=Weakness of Ying Qi · Choppy=Blood def
Hollow 芤	A scallion stalk — edge but hollow inside	Hemorrhage; Yin Deficiency	Rapid=Yin def w/ Empty-Heat or impending hemorrhage · Empty-Soggy=Loss of Essence or depletion of Blood · Knotted=Yang def or Blood stasis
Leather 革	A drum surface — thick on top, hollow beneath	Severe Kidney-Essence/Kidney-Yin Deficiency	Rapid=Severe Yin def w/ Empty-Heat · Slow=Severe Blood def w/ Blood Stasis · Choppy=Severe Blood def
Firm/Confined 牛	Deep, taut, long, wide, forceful — felt only by heavy pressure	Blood Stasis; Interior Cold; Pain	Tight=Internal Cold · Slow=Internal Cold and Blood stasis · Choppy=Blood stasis

Soggy 濡	A strand of cotton floating on water — thin and indistinct	Dampness w/ Qi def; Yin/Essence Deficiency	Fine=Severe Spleen-Qi def · Choppy=Exhaustion of Blood · Floating=Deficiency of Wei Qi w/ Dampness · Wiry=Dampness w/ Liver-Qi stagnation · Rapid=Damp-Heat
Weak/Frail 弱	Forceless, deep, thin — easily lost with more pressure	Yang Deficiency; Blood Deficiency	Choppy=Blood def · Fine=Severe Blood def · Slow=Yang def · Soggy=Yang def w/ some Dampness
Scattered 散	Flower blossoms lightly scattering — no clear root	Severe Qi and Blood Deficiency; serious condition	Slow=Severe Qi/Yang def · Rapid=Severe Blood def w/ Empty-Heat · Floating=Severe Yuan Qi def w/ floating Yang or Yin Fire
Hidden 伏	Cannot be felt except by pressing to the bone	Severe Yang Deficiency	Full=Qi/Blood stagnation, food retention, Int Cold or Heat · Empty=Severe Yang def w/ Int Cold · Rapid=Interior Heat · Slow=Interior Cold
Moving 動	A bean bouncing in the vessel — short, defined peak	Shock, anxiety, fright; Pain	Rapid=Heat · Slippery=Deficiency of Qi and Phlegm · Empty=Severe depletion of Blood · Weak=Shock
Hasty 促	Rapid + random irregular stops, like a man running then suddenly falling	Severe Heat; Heart-Qi Deficiency; Heart-Fire	Overflowing=Heat in the Stomach · Slippery=Retention of Phlegm-Heat · Wiry=Liver-Fire and Heart-Fire · Fine w/o strength=Collapse of Heart-Qi
Knotted 結	Slow + irregularly missed beats, resumes immediately after	Cold with Heart-Yang Deficiency	Choppy=Blood stasis · Slippery=Retention of Phlegm · Deep=Accumulation in the Interior · Wiry=Disease of the arteries/hypertension
Intermittent 代	Pauses at regular intervals, resumes after	Serious internal organ/Heart problem	—
Hurried/Racing 疾	>7 beats/breath (140–180bpm) — extreme Rapid	Fire exhausting Yin	Floating=Severe Empty-Heat from Yin def · Floating-Empty=Severe Yin def · Slippery=Empty-Heat from Yin def w/ Phlegm · Overflowing=Empty-Heat from Yin def

Bonus, not tested: Wang Shu-He's Ten Strange Pulses (Shi Guai Mai — Pecking Sparrow, Dripping Roof, Frenzied Sesame Seed, Flicking Stone, Uptumed Knife, Seething Cauldron, Spinning Bean, etc.), the Nan Jing Difficulty 58 "Five Kinds of Harm by Cold," Shang Han Lun Six-Conformation pulse correspondences, and the Ling Shu 4 disease-appearance-in-pulses material are explicitly marked as bonus/not tested on the source slides.

Seasonal Pulses

Season	Pulse	Dates	Mechanism
Spring	Wiry 弦	Feb 4 – May 4	Yang Qi wants to arise but Yin/Cold still obstructs release, giving the pulse tension — should be only slightly wiry, not truly Tight
Summer	Flooding 洪	May 5 – Aug 6	Yang Qi, having broken free in Spring, is now completely uninhibited — spreads and soars with complete freedom
Autumn	Hair-like 毛	Aug 7 – Nov 6	Su Wen: "dainty and delicate, like elm pods falling through the air" — Yang Qi desiring to be restrained and collected
Winter	Stone 石	Nov 7 – Feb 3	Yang Qi has been gathered and stored; as it retracts inward, the pulse sinks back down like a stone

The cerebral hemorrhage case: Schrier recounts a teacher, Dr. Lili Hong, who found a strong Flooding pulse on a patient in Winter — already inappropriate for the season. She warned the patient and prescribed herbs; he didn't take them. When Summer arrived, the already-excessive Yang Qi had nowhere left to build except further, "like a volcano erupting" — the patient suffered a cerebral hemorrhage and died. A seasonal pulse is only "normal" when it matches its season with no accompanying abnormal signs.

Pulse Blocks — The Hose Analogy

When Qi flow hits a block (often at Yin/Yang meridian transition points), Schrier compares it to pinching a garden hose: water backs up and feels full/tight right at the pinch point, then comes out weak past the blockage. Needle the exit point of the blocked channel and the entry point of the next channel to release the pinch.

4 · Week 4 — Tongue Diagnosis 舌診

Schrier's contrast with pulse: Qi is Yang (active, quick to shift), so the pulse can change within a single treatment. Blood is Yin (heavier, more stable), so the tongue "doesn't lie" the way a pulse thrown off by a rushed patient can. Telemedicine only gives you one weak leg of the diagnostic stool: no pulse, no abdominal palpation, just a flat video image of the tongue.

Don't Clean Up the Crime Scene

Scraping your tongue right before an appointment is, in Schrier's words, like "cleaning up the crime scene." Chewing candy, coffee, or soda can all distort color and coating temporarily — ask before concluding.

Conditions for Examining the Tongue

Category	Factors
Practitioner-side	Posture, sequence & technique, lighting, season and time of day
Patient-side	Age and constitution, gender, elderly status, habits
External factors distorting the tongue	Food (spicy, colored), tobacco & alcohol, medications, diet

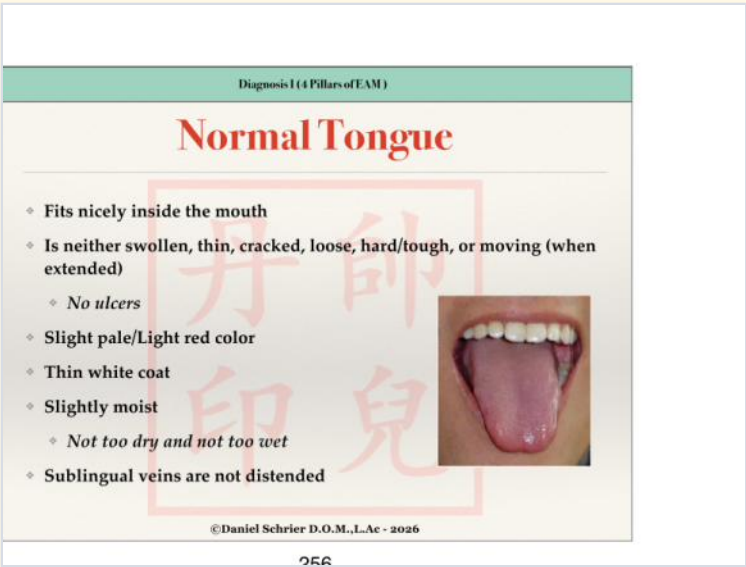
Medication	Tongue Effect
Antibiotics	Peeled patches
Corticosteroids	Red and swollen; tip much redder
Bronchodilators	Red tip only, after many years of use
Diuretics	Peeling
Anti-inflammatories	Red points on tongue; thin body
Antineoplastics (chemo)	Very thick brown or black, dry coating

Division of the Tongue & Corresponding Zang-Fu

Organ	Functional Basis
Heart	Tongue is the "sprout" of the Heart; the Heart opens to the tongue and enables both taste discrimination and speech
Spleen	Tongue is the external sign of the Spleen — root of Qi, Blood, and Body Fluids that nourish the tongue; also controls the muscles and tongue movement
Liver	Controls the tendons, which affects tongue movement
Lung	Passes through the throat and connects to the tongue; the filiform papillae depend on Body Fluids distributed by the Lung

Zone	Organ
Tip	Heart
Front third	Lung (also breast/chest region on the sides; mapping is contralateral for breast health)
Center	Spleen/Stomach
Sides	Liver/Gallbladder
Rear	Kidney/Bladder/Intestines

The Normal Tongue



Normal tongue reference — Prof. Schrier's Week 4 slides.

Fits nicely inside the mouth; neither swollen, thin, cracked, loose, hard/tough, nor moving when extended; no ulcers; slight pale/light red color; thin white coat; slightly moist (not too dry, not too wet); sublingual veins not distended.

Tongue Body Color — Full Detail

Color	Variant	Indication
Pale	Slightly pale, wet	Yang Deficiency
Pale	Slightly pale, dry	Blood Deficiency
Pale	Pale sides	Liver Blood Deficiency
Pale	Pale center	Spleen Blood Deficiency
Pale	Slightly pale (general)	Qi Deficiency
Red	With coating	Full-Heat
Red	Without coating	Empty-Heat
Red	Red and peeled	Heat from Stomach and Kidney Yin Deficiency
Purple	Reddish purple	Heat and Blood stasis
Purple	Reddish purple, distended	Extreme Heat with Blood stasis and toxin from alcohol
Purple	Bluish purple	Blood stasis from internal Cold
Purple	Bluish purple, moist	Blood stasis from internal Cold stiffening tendons/bones
Blue	Blue	Severe internal Cold with Blood stasis
Blue	Blue without coating	Severe internal Cold with stasis and exhaustion of Blood
Blue	Blue central surface	Spleen-Yang deficiency with retention of Phlegm in the chest

Purple always = Blood Stasis, no exceptions. Shade (reddish vs. bluish) tells you Heat vs. Cold; location tells you which organ.

Tongue Body Shape

Normal shape: supple, neither too flabby nor too stiff, no cracks, does not tremble, neither swollen nor thin, no ulcers. Shape usually only changes when pathology persists over time.

Finding	Indication
Thin	Blood or Yin Deficiency (pale=Blood def; red without coating=Yin def)
Swollen	Dampness or Phlegm (could also be due to Heat)
Stiff	Interior Wind or Blood stasis (potentially severe Yin deficiency)
Flaccid	Deficiency of Body Fluids, Blood Deficiency
Long	Heat
Short	Severe Yang deficiency (if wet) or severe Yin deficiency (if peeled without coating)
Deviated	Exterior Wind invading channels (normal color) or Interior Liver Wind (red or normal color)
Moving	Heart Fire and internal Wind (red body); Spleen Heat with exhaustion of Body Fluids (red and dry body)
Quivering	Spleen Qi deficiency (pale body); extreme Heat generating internal Wind (red body); collapse of Heart/Spleen Qi (pale body); collapse of Yang (pale, thin body)
Rolled (tip)	Heat from excess (tip rolled over); Deficiency Heat (tip rolled under)
Tooth-marked	Spleen Qi deficiency
Ulcerated	Blazing Heart Fire (red body); Heart Heat from Kidney Yin deficiency (red and peeled body); Spleen and Kidney Heat (red body)

Cracked Tongue — Location Determines Meaning

Diagnosis I (4 Pillars of TCM)

Cracked Tongue

- ♦ **Horizontal Cracks:** Yin Deficiency of Stomach and/or Kidney
- ♦ **Irregular Cracks:** Stomach Yin deficiency
- ♦ **Stomach Crack (central and wide in center):** Stomach Yin Deficiency
- ♦ **Heart Crack:** Constitutional tendency to heart patterns or emotional stress
- ♦ **Deep Midline with Small Cracks:** Kidney Yin Deficiency
- ♦ **Short Transverse Crack:** Spleen Yin Deficiency
- ♦ **Short Diagonal in Lung:** Lung disease (pneumonia, whooping cough)

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Crack patterns and locations — Prof. Schrier's Week 4 slides.

Crack Type	Indication
Horizontal cracks	Yin Deficiency of Stomach and/or Kidney
Irregular cracks	Stomach Yin deficiency
Stomach crack (central, wide in center)	Stomach Yin Deficiency
Heart crack	Constitutional tendency to Heart patterns or emotional stress
Deep midline with small cracks	Kidney Yin Deficiency
Short transverse crack	Spleen Yin Deficiency
Short diagonal crack (Lung zone)	Lung disease (e.g. pneumonia, whooping cough)

Tongue Coating — The Grass-and-Soil Analogy

Schrier's image for "rooting": the coating should "grow" out of the tongue body the way grass grows out of soil, with roots. A coating without root looks like it's been added on top, or like scattered grass after a mowing.

Concept	Detail
General principle	Reflects the state of the Yang organs, particularly Stomach (Kidney also plays a role in formation); reflects Heat/Cold and Excess/Deficiency
Normal coating	Thin, white, "properly" moist (neither slippery nor dry), thin enough to see the body color through it
Thick coating	Always indicates a pathogenic factor — the thicker, the stronger the pathogen
With coating + root	Stomach Qi is still intact, even if thickness/color is pathological
Without coating	Stomach Qi and Yin severely weakened — Deficiency
Without root, thin	Early stage of weakening Stomach
Without root, thick	Strong pathogenic factor with weak Stomach
Coating Color	Indication
White	Cold pattern
Yellow	Full-Heat pattern
Grey/Black	Extreme Cold or extreme Heat (tongue wet or dry, respectively)
White Coating Variant	Indication
Thin	Normal, mild, or early stage of disease; exterior pattern (Wind-Cold, Wind-Damp, Cold-Damp)
Thick and greasy	Spleen/Stomach Yang deficiency with accumulation of food and Dampness; turbid Dampness or Phlegm accumulation
Thick, greasy, glossy	Spleen-Yang deficiency with retention of cold-damp phlegm; interior Cold with Phlegm and Dampness
Dry and thin	Wind-Heat invades, or dryness attacks the Lungs
Dry and thick	Early stage of febrile disease, Body Fluids injured by excess Heat
Powdery	Toxic Heat in the interior, seen in contagious epidemic diseases
Yellow Coating Variant	Indication
Pale yellow	Mild Heat
Dark yellow	Severe Heat
Brown-yellow	Heat accumulation
Dirty yellow	Damp-Heat in the Stomach and Intestines
Yellow, sticky and greasy	Heat and Phlegm
Dry yellow	Heat-injured Fluids
Yellow root, white tip	Exterior pathogen just changing into Heat, penetrating to the interior
Gray/Black Coating Variant	Indication
Gray, wet and slippery	Damp-Cold in the Spleen
Gray and dry	Heat from excess
Black, slippery and greasy	Damp-Cold in the Stomach and Intestines
White coating with black points	Exterior pathogen penetrating to the interior, transforming into Heat
White coating with black prickles	True Cold, false Heat — Cold turned into Heat
Black in center, white/slippery sides	Spleen-Yang deficiency with Damp-Cold in the interior
Yellow sides, black/greasy center	Damp-Heat in the Spleen and Stomach
Black, dry and cracked	Exhaustion of Kidneys; Yang deficiency with interior Cold

Coating Moisture, Viscosity & Distribution

Aspect	Finding	Indication
Moisture	Glossy (wet to dripping)	Cold syndrome; Damp/Phlegm/water accumulation; Yang Deficiency (Yang Qi fails to transform, becomes water)
Moisture	Rough (sandpaper-like)	Severe injury to Body Fluids
Viscosity	Moldy (thick, patchy, coarse granules)	Food stagnation, Phlegm, internal abscess
Viscosity	Greasy (fine particles, thick middle/ thin margins)	Dampness, Phlegm, food stagnation
Distribution	Front half only	Pathogenic factor entering the interior but not yet deep
Distribution	Rear half only	Mild exterior pathogen invading with Stomach dysfunction
Distribution	One side only	Pathogenic factor in the Shao Yang
Distribution	Absent in center	Stomach or Kidney Yin deficiency, or deficiency of Yin/Essence/Qi/Blood

Sublingual Veins

Finding	Indication
Distended, not dark	Qi Deficiency
Thin	Yin Deficiency
Distended and dark	Blood Stasis in the Upper Burner
Dark and dry	Severe Yin deficiency with Empty-Heat
Dark, swollen, wet	Lung, Spleen, and Kidney Deficiency
Reddish and shiny	Damp-Heat
White and slippery	Cold-Dampness

Deficiency Patterns by Organ — Full Reference

Deficiency Type	Organ	Tongue Finding
Qi	Lung	Body slightly flaccid, slightly swollen anteriorly
Qi	Spleen	Tooth-marked
Qi	Stomach	Lack of coating in the center
Qi	Heart	Body pale
Yang	Spleen	Body pale, coating white and wet
Yang	Kidney	Body pale and swollen, coating white
Yang	Heart	Body pale, bluish-purple if severe
Blood	Spleen	Body pale, slightly dry
Blood	Heart	Body pale, tip paler
Blood	Liver	Body pale, sides paler
Yin	Stomach	No coating in center, dry, wide crack in the center
Yin	Kidney	Body red, no coating, dry, cracks
Yin	Heart	Body red, no coating anteriorly, tip redder
Yin	Lung	Body red, no coating, cracks anteriorly

Excess/Deficiency and Cold/Heat — Tongue Summary

Principle	Tongue Correlate
Exterior	Wind-Cold = thin white coat; Wind-Heat = thin white coat initially, then yellow
Interior	Tongue's body color and shape altered
Cold (Deficiency)	White coating, pale body
Heat	Red body, yellow coating
Excess (general)	Coating thick
Excess — Cold	Body pale, coating thick, slippery, and white
Excess — Heat	Body red, coating thick and yellow
Excess — Blood Stasis	Body purple
Excess — Phlegm	Coating thick, slippery, and greasy

Tongue Observation Process (Quick Version)

Question
Does the tongue seem to have good Qi? · Does it come out with good posture, or is it floppy/over-extended/stiff/retracted? · Is the tongue moist? · Does the tongue stick out, and how far? · Is the body pale, red, or purple?

Clinical case (bonus material): a Wuhan COVID-19 patient treated with Da Cheng Qi Tang showed a thick yellow coating with cracked, petal-like fissures before treatment; after 2 days of herbal treatment the coating had visibly thinned, and by day 3 it was substantially clearer — a documented example of tongue coating tracking treatment response in real time. ZheJiang Chinese Medical University's COVID-19 discussion also noted: tongue findings ranged bright red to dull purple with yellow or thick greasy fur, correlating with Xie Qi invading the Lung and Wei Qi, and heat penetrating deeper into the interior.

Diagnosis I (4 Pillars of TCM)

❖ Pale Purple tongue

❖ Blood Deficiency with some Blood Stagnation

❖ Swollen, Tooth-marked Tongue

❖ Yang Deficiency, Fluid accumulation, SP Qi Deficiency

❖ Concave in Lower Burner

❖ Kidney Deficiency

❖ Wet tongue

❖ Yang Deficiency/Dampness



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Case example: dark, distended sublingual veins indicating Blood Stagnation — Prof. Schrier's Week 4 slides.

5 · Week 6 — Diagnosis by Observation 望診

Schrier opens this unit with the legend of Biǎn Què, one of the earliest famous physicians in Chinese medical history, who was given a secret formula that let him "see through walls." His point: you're not getting X-ray vision from a cereal-box novelty, but you are developing the real version of that power. You've already started doing it with the tongue. Observation trains that same seeing-through-the-surface skill on the rest of the body.

Method

Method	Uses
Inspection	Eyes: vitality, color, appearance, secretions (incl. tongue)
Auscultation/Olfaction	Ears (listen) + nose (smell)
Inquiry	Verbal questioning
Palpation	Touch, incl. pulse

Quick Recall: Zang-Xiang = what's inside shows on the outside. The body is a microsystem of microsystems — face, tongue, ear, hand, and foot all independently map the whole body (distal acupuncture, e.g. LI4 for the head/face, works on this same "light switch across the room" principle).

Shen (Vitality) — Full Classification

Su Wen 43: the Shen is stored in the eyes; when restless, it withers and the sparkle fades. Schrier's illustration: even an unsettling character actor still has a visible twinkle on screen; the flat, empty stare of a mugshot or a horror-film "possessed" gaze is genuinely missing that light.

Category	Manifestation
Having Shen (yǒu shén)	Alert, bright eyes, clear consciousness and speech, quick responses, resonant voice, radiant complexion with natural expression
Fatigued Shen (shén pī)	Listlessness, lassitude, poor memory, weak/low voice, aversion to speaking, fatigue, slow and awkward actions
Loss of Shen (shǎo shén)	Dull eyes, slow/awkward action, blurred vision, dull complexion and expression, heaviness of the body, obtuse actions, mental confusion, unconsciousness, delirium, hallucinations
False Shen (ji· shén)	In critical condition: listless, unconscious, dull eyes, low feeble voice, dull complexion, anorexia — THEN a sudden jolt: alert, bright eyes, louder voice, flushed cheeks, improved appetite

Observation	Having Shen	Loss of Shen	False Shen
Complexion	Bright and moist	Dim, dull sheen	Dull, then suddenly lustrous
Eyes	Alert, vivid, twinkle	Dull, blurred vision	Dull, then suddenly bright
Mind/Speech	Clear speech, conscious, agile	Unconscious, delirious	Unclear, then sudden change
Motion/Response	Quick, appropriate	Sluggish and slow	Suddenly responsive
Respiration	Even	Rapid, feeble, or difficult	Feeble, then briefly steady
Diet/Appetite	Strong	Poor	Improved (temporarily)

False Shen — back to the candle: a low-burning candle can flare brighter right before going out — like a sailor's "green flash" at sunset. Schrier's family story: a dying relative held on, fully alert and vocal, until one last sibling arrived, then passed shortly after. False Shen is the fire's last flare, not a genuine turnaround.

Deranged Shen Patterns

Term	Presentation
Fán zào	Irritability with hot/feverish sensation; may drive the patient to prefer nudity or jump into water
Zàng zào (Visceral Agitation)	Mental depression, hallucination, disorientation, frequent crying spells, bouts of yawning, no loss of consciousness
Bǎi hé bìng (Lily disease)	Chronic depression, apathy, aversion to speaking/mumbling to self, insomnia, anorexia, sleepwalking
Diān (Yin madness)	Chronic depression, aversion to speaking or mumbling to self, inappropriate laughing/crying
Kuáng (Yang madness)	Raving with obscenities, restlessness, singing loudly in high places, wandering naked, hitting people or destroying things

Su Wen 32 — Face Heat Map

Schrier’s holiday mnemonic: "why does Rudolph have a red nose? Why does Santa?" — too many cookies, Spleen-associated Heat (nose maps to Spleen).

Region (patient's own left/right)	Organ
L cheek (patient's)	Liver
Forehead	Heart
Nose	Spleen
R cheek (patient's)	Lung
Chin	Kidney

The mirror trap: a near-guaranteed quiz item. Drawing the face map facing yourself puts Liver on YOUR left as you look at the page — but that’s the patient’s left cheek. Schrier admits marking his own quizzes wrong on this.

Complexion Variables & Attributes

Concept	Detail
Facial Color	Color of the skin; associated with Blood and Yin
Facial Sheen	Luster of the skin, moisture; associated with Qi and Yang
Constitutional (True) Color	The individual’s inherent color, unchanged during life
Guest/Visitor Color	Slight changes following seasonal/climatic shifts, environment, or physical activity
Normal Complexion	Subtle, slightly reddish hue; "contained" color with gentle luster

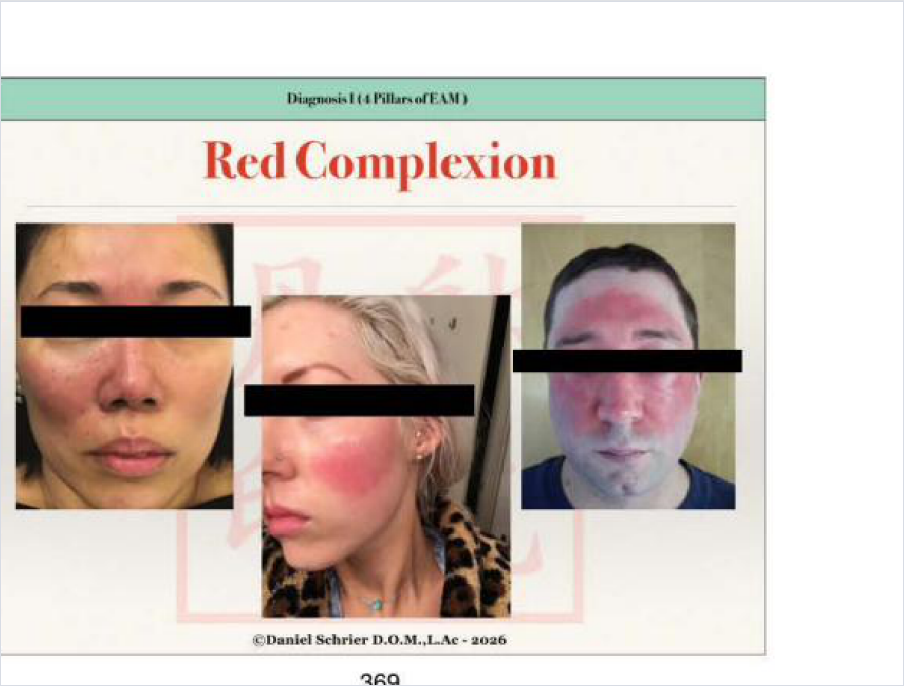
Attribute	Finding	Indication
Brightness	Dull/dim	Cold or Dark pattern; Yin pattern
Thickness	Thick color	Excess pattern
Thickness	Thin color	Deficiency pattern

Five Colors of the Face — Full Sub-Variants

Variant	Indication
Pale White/Dull White (withered)	Qi or Blood Deficiency
Bright White (puffy, bloated)	Yang Deficiency
Pale Blue-White	Cold with Yang Deficiency

Yellow Variant	Indication
Bright Yellow (Yang jaundice)	Damp-Heat
Dull/Dark Yellow (Yin jaundice)	Cold-Damp / Spleen deficiency

Red Variant	Indication
Red over entire face	Full/Excess Heat
Red cheeks (malar) only	Empty/Deficient Heat
Superficial zygomatic flush with pale face beneath	Floating Yang (serious — Yin failing to hold Yang down)



Red Complexion presentations (redacted for privacy) — Prof. Schrier's Week 6 slides. Used for internal class study only.

Green Variant	Indication
Pale green under eyes	Liver Qi Stagnation (also seen as Liver Blood Deficiency, per location)
Green on cheeks	Liver Qi Stagnation, Liver Blood Stasis, Cold in Liver, or Liver Wind
Green with red tinge	Shao Yang pattern (TH/GB)
Green with red eyes	Liver Fire
Yellow-green cheeks	Phlegm with Liver Yang Rising
Green nose	Stagnation of Qi with abdominal pain
Dark red-green	Stagnant Liver Qi turning into Heat

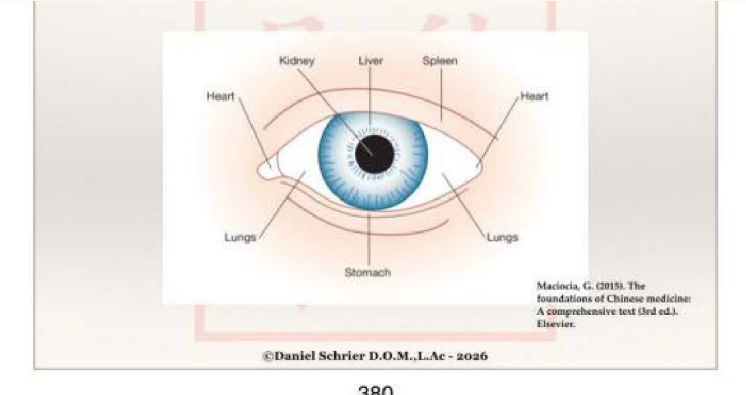
Black/Grayish Variant	Indication
Dark (black) and dry	Kidney Yin Deficiency with Empty Heat
Dark and dried up/ burnt	Kidney Essence exhaustion
Black without luster, dry and scaly	Kidney Yang Deficiency
Black around the eyes	Kidney Deficiency or Blood Stasis

Inspection of the Eyes

Ling Shu 80: "the essence from the five Zang and six Fu flow upwards to irrigate the eyes." The Liver opens into the eyes and stores the Blood that allows the Mind to see and distinguish color; tears moisten the eyes under Liver governance.

Significance of Eye Inspection

Identify pathogenic factors and thermal nature · Identify the Zang-Fu organs involved · Understand the current state of those organs · Make a prognosis



Five Wheels of the Eye — source: Maciocia, *Foundations of Chinese Medicine* (3rd ed.), via Prof. Schrier's Week 6 slides.

Wheel	Structure	Organ
Blood	Inner/outer canthus	Heart
Qi	Sclera (white)	Lung
Wind	Iris	Liver
Water	Pupil	Kidney
Flesh	Eyelids	Spleen

Ling Shu (Qi Bo's reply): "the essence of the bones collects in the pupils; the essence of the sinews collects in the black parts (iris); the essence of the blood collects in the network vessels (canthi); the essence of the qi collects in the white of the eyes (sclera); the essence of the sinews and flesh collects in the eyelids."

Inspecting the Shen of the Eye

	Manifestation	Indications	Prognosis
Having Shen	Clear vision, bright shiny luster, distinguishable iris/pupil, clear flexible movement, little tear/eye secretion	Strong Liver and Kidney Qi; Mild Illness	Good, relatively easy to treat
Lack of Shen	Poor vision, dull luster, turbid hue in sclera/iris/pupil, borders indistinguishable, no tears or secretion	Poor Liver and Kidney Qi; Stronger illness	Poor, relatively difficult to treat

Eye Color Diagnosis

Yellow in Sclera/Eyes	Accompanying Signs	Indication
Bright yellow, tangerine-peel	Thirst, dry mouth, heat, bitter taste, epigastric fullness, sticky taste, heaviness; T: Red sticky coat; P: Slippery Rapid	Damp-Heat, Heat predominant
Dull yellow	Thirst w/o desire to drink, epigastric fullness, sticky taste, heaviness; T: Sticky yellow; P: Slippery Rapid	Damp-Heat, Damp predominant
Dull dark yellow	Thirst w/o desire, epigastric fullness, cold limbs; T: Sticky white; P: Slippery Slow	Cold and Damp
Deep yellow, bloodshot	Fever, feeling of heat, agitation, red skin rashes, headache; T: Red w/ points, thick coat; P: Slippery Rapid Overflowing	Toxic Heat
Dark dull yellow/brown	Dark rings under eyes, headache, abdominal pain, agitation; T: Purple; P: Wiry Choppy	Blood Stasis

Red in Eyes	Location/Accompanying	Indication
Red in canthus area	—	Heat in the Heart
Redness and swelling, entire eye	Headache, easily angered	Rising Liver Fire or exterior Wind-Heat
Red sclera	Cough	Heat in the Lung

Blue-Green/Dark in Eyes	Accompanying Signs	Indication
Blue-green sclera	Tinnitus, headache, numbness of limbs; T: Stiff/Deviated; P: Wiry	Liver Wind
—	Abdominal pain, chronic pain, abundant pale urine; T: Pale; P: Tight and Slow	Internal Cold
—	Poor memory, night sweating, dry mouth/throat, low back ache, scanty dark urine, tiredness; T: Normal, no coat; P: Floating Empty	Kidney Yin Deficiency
Dark sclera, black eye sockets	Obesity, dizziness, sensation of heaviness in the head, feeling of muzziness, weakness, cold limbs	Retention of Turbid Phlegm; Yang Deficiency with Liver/Kidney Yin issues
Dark, brownish sclera	Dizziness, tinnitus, irritability, red tongue, thirst	Liver and Kidney Deficiency

White in Eyes	Accompanying Signs	Indication
White rings around iris	—	Liver and Kidney Yin Deficiency
Iris gradually turning white	Dim vision, cold limbs, loose stools	Yang Deficiency
Pale white blood vessels in canthus	Pale tongue and face	Blood Deficiency

Color	General Mechanism (Overview)
Red	Pathogenic Heat injuring blood vessels or causing Blood to rise upward
White	Lack of Blood to fill the vessels (Qi/Blood Deficiency, or Yang Deficiency with Cold obstructing vessels)
Yellow	Liver/Gallbladder obstructed by Dampness or Qi/Blood stasis, generating Heat that steams bile and rises to the eyes
Black	Extreme Heat consuming Body Fluids and concentrating the Blood; also associated with Kidney failure
Blue-Green	Wind or Liver dysfunction

Eye Shape & Movement

Finding	Indication
Sunken (general)	Less nourishment and support
Sunken, following prolonged vomiting	Spleen Qi Deficiency; or Collapse of Yin/Yang (severe cases)
Swollen (Heat/Damp accumulation)	Sudden onset, red/swollen/itchy, possible sores = Wind-Heat toxin; puffy without pain, shiny/colorless = Edema/Water retention; slow painless swelling both lids = Spleen deficiency with Damp
Bulging (general)	Exuberant Zheng Qi struggling against excessive pathogens, pushing the eyeball outward
Bulging + headache/ irritability, red tongue, yellow greasy coat	Liver Yang Rising with Heat
Bulging + neck swelling, dizziness, tinnitus, five-center heat	Yin Deficiency with relative Yang Excess
Bulging + neck swelling, headache, double vision, purple tongue w/ spots	Blood Stagnation
Strabismus, sudden, no redness/swelling, one eye, w/ deviated mouth	Wind attacking the channels
Strabismus + nausea, fatigue, chest tightness, greasy coat, slippery pulse	Damp-Phlegm obstructing the channels
Eyelid spasm, thin/ pale face and lips, thready pulse	Blood Deficiency
Eyelid spasm + frequent blinking, heaviness/fatigue, poor appetite, flabby tongue	Spleen Deficiency with Dampness
Drooping eyelid, slow onset, fatigue, organ prolapse, weak pulse	Qi Sinking
Drooping eyelid, acute onset, itching/ numbness, aversion to cold/fever, floating pulse	Wind attacking the channels

Hair

Finding	Indication
Falling hair	Kidney Jing or Blood Deficiency
Prematurely greying hair	Kidney Essence Deficiency
Dull and brittle hair	Liver Blood Deficiency

Quick Recall: hair state reflects Blood or Kidney Essence — Schrier connects this directly to why national leaders visibly grey so fast in office: chronic stress burns Kidney Essence "at both ends."

Nose

Finding	Indication
Green/blue tip	Abdominal pain from Cold
Yellow tip	Damp-Heat in the Spleen
Red tip	Heat in Lung and Spleen
Greenish bridge	Liver-Qi stagnation
Red bridge	Liver Fire
Slightly moist and shiny	Good prognosis
Dry nose	Heat in Stomach or Large Intestine
Clear watery discharge	Cold pattern
Thick yellow discharge	Heat pattern (with some Dampness)
Flaring nostrils + high fever	Extreme Heat in the Lungs
Epistaxis (nosebleed)	Excess Heat attacking Lung and Stomach

Ears

Finding	Indication
Swelling & pain, middle ear	Heat in Shao Yang (TH/GB) channels
Thin ear	Deficiency of Qi or Blood
Long, full ear lobe	Strong constitution
Small lobe	Poor constitution
White ears	Cold pattern
Bluish/dark ears	Pain caused by Cold
Dry, withered, dark lobes	Exhaustion of Kidney-Qi (usually Kidney-Yin)
Shiny, moist lobes	Good prognosis
Dry, withered lobes	Poor prognosis

Ear Discharge	Indication
Clear	Cold
Foul, purulent	Damp-Heat
Bloody	Heat
Yellow	Damp accumulation

Teeth & Gums

Teeth Finding	Indication
Dry, without sheen	Kidney Deficiency, Body Fluid injury
Dull, like a "soy bean"	Severe Kidney failure/exhaustion
Loose teeth	Kidney Deficiency

Gum Finding	Indication
Moist, normal	Normal
Deep red with swelling	Excess Heat in Yang Ming
Atrophied gums	Kidney Deficiency
Ulceration or bleeding, with pain/swelling	Stomach Fire Rising
Chronic bleeding, no pain	Blood Deficiency
Dark line between teeth and gums	Heavy metal (e.g. mercury) poisoning

Lips & Mouth

Normal lips are red, lustrous, and moist — neither swollen nor atrophied, neither deviated nor shaking, with free flexible movement.

Finding	Indication
Pale lips + pale tongue	Blood Deficiency or Yang Deficiency
Pale lips + fatigue	Qi Deficiency
Crimson lips	Deficiency Heat
Purple lips	Interior Cold or Blood Stasis
Swollen lips, thirst with desire to drink	Excess Interior Heat
Swollen lips, no thirst	Spleen/Stomach Dampness
Chapped/dry lips	Lung/Stomach Fluid damage or Wind due to Stomach Fire
Deviated mouth, one side, no pain	Wind attack in the collaterals
Deviated mouth + bitter taste, red face	Heat toxins injuring the collaterals
Sudden open mouth, drooling, loss of consciousness	Wind-Phlegm (critical)
Mouth closed tightly (trismus)	Wind

Throat, Pharynx & Tonsils

Finding	Indication
Deep red	Heat (interior or exterior)
Pale red	Empty-Heat
Acute pain, redness, swelling	Invasion of Wind-Heat
Chronic pain, redness, swelling	Stomach-Heat
Chronically sore/dry, not swollen or red	Lung and/or Kidney Yin Deficiency with Empty-Heat
Chronic erosion, raised hard-edged ulcers	Blood Stasis with Phlegm-Heat
Swollen tonsils, normal color	Damp/Phlegm retention against a background of Qi Deficiency
Acutely red, swollen tonsils with exudate	Wind-Heat invasion complicated by Toxic Heat in Stomach/Large Intestine
Grey-ish tonsils	Acute stage of glandular fever (mononucleosis)

Limbs, Joints & Movement Disorders

Category	Pattern
Edema, hands	Lung–Yang Deficiency
Edema, feet	Kidney–Yang Deficiency
Edema, all four limbs	Spleen–Yang Deficiency
Edema, non–pitting	Retention of Dampness or Qi Stagnation
Acute hand edema	Invasion of Lungs by Wind–Water
Flaccidity (soft, limp, not atrophied)	Wind–Heat injuring Lung/Body Fluids (acute); Damp–Heat in Stomach/Spleen; Spleen/Stomach Qi Deficiency; Kidney–Yin Deficiency
Rigidity, sudden onset	Invasion of Wind
Rigidity, chronic, elderly	Liver–Yang Rising or Liver–Wind
Rigidity + pain worse at night	Blood Stasis
Paralysis, main causes	Stomach/Spleen Deficiency; Liver/Kidney Yin Deficiency; Dampness w/ Heat (Full); Phlegm and internal Wind in channels (with underlying Qi/Blood Deficiency)
Contraction, sudden	Invasion of Wind (Full: Dampness obstructing muscles/fluids)
Contraction, chronic	Liver–Blood or Liver–Yin Deficiency (Empty)
Tremor of the hands	Liver–Wind
Tremor, elderly, all limbs	Liver–Wind and Phlegm affecting channels/sinews
Fine tremor in women	Liver–Wind from Liver–Blood Deficiency
Mild fine tremor	General Qi/Blood Deficiency
Spasticity + tremor in febrile disease	Liver–Wind or Empty–Wind from Yin Deficiency

Nails

Finding	Indication
Normal	Rosy, shiny, appropriately thick, without roughness
Nail bed white on pressure, color returns immediately	Sufficient Qi and Blood (normal)
White on pressure, color returns slowly	Exhaustion of Qi and Blood
Pale color	Deficiency (Qi/Blood)
Purple/bluish color	Blood Stasis
Rough, thick, lusterless, loss of transparency	Qi/Blood Deficiency w/ Wind attack or Damp invasion causing stagnation
Ridges	Blood Deficiency with Liver–Yang Rising, or Qi/Blood Deficiency
Hook-shaped	Qi/Blood stagnation or Wind–painful obstruction
Spoon-shaped	Malnutrition, Spleen Deficiency
Twisted and bent	Liver–Qi Deficiency or Liver–Blood stagnation

Thenar Eminence Vein Color	Indication
Bluish, veins visible	Cold in the Stomach
Bluish and short	Empty pattern
Red veins	Heat in the Stomach
Purple veins	Blood Stasis in the Stomach

Skin

Skin Color	Indication
Jaundice, bright yellow	Yang Jaundice, Damp-Heat
Jaundice, dull yellow	Yin Jaundice, Cold-Damp
White patches, clear margin	Vitiligo from Wind-Damp attack disharmonizing Qi and Blood

Skin Moisture	Indication
Normal moisture	Exuberance of Lung Qi, sufficient Body Fluids
Generalized dry skin	Blood or Body Fluid Deficiency
Dry skin with scales	Blood Stasis

Skin Lesion	Description
Papule (zhěn)	"Rash," seed-sized, red, distinct borders, raised, color disappears with pressure
Macule (bān)	"Plaque," flat, red patch, clear border, does not disappear with pressure
Blister (pào zhěn)	Raised surface, varies in size, contains clear or turbid fluid
Nodule (jiǒ jié)	Localized, felt under the skin

Quick Recall (Excreta/Secretions general rule): white/clear/thin/formless/no odor = Cold or Deficiency. Yellow/thick/strong odor = Heat or Excess.

Demeanor & Body Movements

Finding	Pattern
Excess of movement	Yang/Full/Heat
Lack of movement	Yin/Empty/Cold
Quick movements + feeling of Heat	Excess Yang
Small movements, continuous fidgeting (esp. legs)	Empty-Heat
Tremors, convulsions	Liver-Wind (Full-Wind)
Fine tremors, tics	Liver-Wind (Empty-Wind)
Paralysis	Internal Wind
Stiffness and rigidity	Qi stagnation, Blood stasis, or internal Wind

Body Shape

Finding	Pattern
Large, barrel-like chest/epigastrium	Full condition of Lungs and/or Stomach
Large, overweight thighs	Spleen deficiency
Thin body overall	Yin deficiency
Overweight body overall	Yang deficiency with Phlegm

6 · Week 7 — Diagnosis by Inquiry 問診

Schrier opens by naming a historical precedent for tailoring the question order: Zhāng Zhòngjǐng always started with Cold and Fever — essentially asking "is this an Exterior or an Interior pattern?" before anything else. Schrier's own approach is looser: follow the patient's chief complaint first, then let that complaint's logic dictate which of the 16 Questions actually matter. A straightforward musculoskeletal injury doesn't need an exhaustive dietary interrogation the way a case of stomach cramps and acid reflux obviously does — though he still holds that diet is worth asking about in nearly every case, "because what are you feeding your muscles? What are you feeding your bones?"

The 16 Questions — Asked Loosely, Not Rigidly

Topic	Detail
10 vs 16 Questions	Maciocia's 10: chills/fever, sweating, head/body, 2 excretions, diet, chest/abdomen, hearing, thirst/drink, previous illness, cause. Schrier's 16 adds Pain, Emotions, Sexual Symptoms, Energy Level.
16 in order	1 Pain · 2 Food/Taste · 3 Stools/Urine · 4 Thirst/Drink · 5 Energy · 6 Head/Face/Body · 7 Chest/Abdomen · 8 Limbs · 9 Sleep · 10 Sweating · 11 Ears/Eyes · 12 Cold/Heat/Fever · 13 Emotional · 14 Sexual · 15 Women's · 16 Children's
Golden Rule	Every question should confirm or exclude a pattern — never recite the 16 as a rote script; always ask why. Ask about family/social life and sleep without being invasive — you're gathering the emotional and lifestyle context (work hours, caregiving burden, commute) that often explains why a pattern developed in the first place.

Schrier illustrates why lifestyle questions matter with a deliberately exaggerated commuter example: someone caring for an ill parent who commutes hours each way, works all day, comes home to caregiving duties, and finally gets to bed near midnight only to wake at 3am to do it again — that schedule alone explains a Qi and Blood deficiency picture without needing any other cause. He also encourages asking what's going well in the patient's life, not only what's wrong, since practitioners can otherwise slide into only ever hearing the negative.

Q1 — Pain

Topic	Detail
3 mechanisms (Neijing)	Circulation impeded (Su Wen 39) · Tension (Su Wen 39/62, Ling Shu 10) · Lack of nourishment
Full vs Empty pain	Full: aggravated by food/BM/vomiting/pressure, relieved by rest, sharp, worse w/ movement. Empty: alleviated by food/BM/rest/pressure, dull, better w/ movement.
Pain character	Distending/moving=Qi stagnation · boring/stabbing fixed=Blood stasis · cramping+cold=Cold · burning+fullness=Heat · intense+fullness=food retention

Wandering Bi — the hot dog cart analogy: Schrier's image for Wind-type Bi Syndrome: paying a food-truck vendor on a windy day and your money blows out of your hand — it drifts one way, you chase it, it flips another way. That's Wind: pain that isn't anchored anywhere, moving joint to joint. Compare that to Painful Bi (severe, fixed pain from Cold), Fixed Bi (soreness/heaviness from Damp), Heat Bi (sudden swelling and redness), and Bone Bi (chronic, deep, a progression of the other four).

Bi Syndrome	Pathogen	Character
Wandering	Wind	Moves joint to joint, nothing fixed
Painful	Cold	Severe, fixed pain
Fixed	Damp	Soreness and heaviness
Heat	Heat	Sudden onset, swelling, redness
Bone	Chronic, deep	Progression of the other four; joint deformity

Q2–4 — Food, Taste, Stools, Urine, Thirst

Schrier widens "appetite" beyond food itself: the Stomach's job is reception — receiving food and drink, but by extension, receiving information. A student who's lost interest in the material, or who can't tolerate a particular environment, is showing the same "poor reception" logic in a different domain. Ravenous appetite doesn't automatically mean Stomach Fire, either — he flags parasites (tapeworms) as a real differential to rule out before settling on a Heat diagnosis, and reminds students to check for the fuller Stomach-Heat picture (burning sensation, acid regurgitation, red tongue redder in the center, possible central cracking) before committing.

Topic	Mapping
Appetite	Lack=SP-Qi def · excessive=ST-Heat (rule out parasites first) · fullness=Dampness/food retention · distention=Qi stagnation
Taste	Bitter=Liver/Heart Heat · sweet=SP def or Damp-Heat · sour=food retention or LR invading ST · salty=KD-Yin def · pungent=LU-Heat
Stools	Better after BM=Full · worse after BM=Empty · undigested food=SP-Qi def · black/dark=Blood stasis · alternating constip/diarrhea=stagnant LR-Qi invading SP
Urine color	Pale=Cold · dark=Heat · turbid/cloudy=Dampness
Urine pain timing	Before=Qi stagnation Lower Burner · during=Damp-Heat Bladder · after=Qi deficiency
Thirst	Cold drinks desired=Heat · warm drinks desired=Cold · no thirst=Cold/no Heat · thirst but no desire to drink=Damp-Heat or Yin def

Q5, Q9, Q10 — Energy, Sleep, Sweating

"I'm so tired" is, in Schrier's words, not enough information — "tell me more" is doing most of the diagnostic work here. He contrasts two tiredness pictures that patients might otherwise describe the same way: chronic tiredness with a desire to lie down, poor appetite, and loose stools points toward Spleen (or Spleen-Yang) Deficiency, while chronic tiredness with a weak voice and a tendency to catch colds easily points toward Lung Qi Deficiency instead — because Lung and Spleen are the two organs that generate postnatal Qi (Lung from air, Spleen from food/drink), and the accompanying signs tell you which one is actually short.

Topic	Mapping
Tiredness	AM worse=SP/ST-Yang def · weak voice+catches colds=LU-Qi def · feeling cold=KD-Yang def · heaviness=Dampness · muzzy+dizzy=Phlegm · distention+irritable+Wiry=LR-Qi stagnation
Sleep physiology	Depends on Blood/Yin of Heart & Liver; Spleen also influences. Shen and Hun need anchoring by HT/LR Blood.
Insomnia types	Can't fall/stay asleep=Blood def not anchoring Shen/Hun (Empty). Restless+heat+dreaming=pathogens agitating Shen/Hun (Full). Wake many times=Yin def w/ Empty Heat. Wake early=GB deficiency.
Sweat location	Head only=ST Heat/Damp-Heat · whole body=LU-Qi def · palms/soles/chest=Yin def (5-palm heat) · day=Yang def · night=Yin def

Not tested: Categories of Dreams / Neijing dream chapters (Su Wen 17, 80; Ling Shu 43) are explicitly marked not tested, even though Schrier notes dream content can theoretically point toward specific organs.

Q6 — Head, Face, Body

Schrier repeats the mint-tea caveat from Week 1 here in the specific context of headaches: mint tea disperses Liver-Qi stagnation and helps an Excess-type headache, but the same cooling, dispersing action will make a Deficiency-type headache worse. You have to know which kind you're looking at before recommending it.

Headache Location	Channel	Cause
Nape	Tai Yang	Ext. Wind-Cold or Kidney def
Forehead	Yang Ming	Stomach-Heat or Blood def
Temples/sides	Shao Yang	Ext. Wind or Liver/GB Fire rising
Vertex	Jue Yin	Liver-Blood deficiency

Headache Timing/ Quality	Indication
Daytime	Qi/Yang deficiency
Evening	Blood/Yin deficiency
Night	Blood stasis
Sudden onset, severe giddiness, everything sways	Internal Wind
Throbbing, heaviness, muzzy-headed	Liver Yang rising
Slight dizziness, worse with fatigue	Deficiency (vs. sudden/severe onset = Excess)
Numbness: bilateral vs unilateral	Bilateral=Blood deficiency; Unilateral (esp. first 3 fingers)=Internal Wind + Phlegm, possible impending Wind-stroke

Face Pain and Nosebleeds — Reading the Same Region Through Different Lenses

Schrier uses facial pain to show how the same location can point to different organs depending on the accompanying picture. Forehead pain with red cheeks, thirst, and a bitter taste could be Liver Fire — but the forehead also corresponds to Yang Ming/Stomach, so the same location could instead mean excess Fire invading the Stomach (digestive signs) or the Heart (mental/emotional signs). The differentiator is always the accompanying symptom set, not the location alone.

Bleeding Mechanism	Accompanying Signs	Pattern
Excess pushing blood out	Feeling of heat, thirst, inflamed gums	Fire/Heat (Excess)
Deficiency, not holding	Tiredness, poor appetite, loose stools	Spleen Qi not holding Blood (Deficiency)
Deficiency Heat	Dry mouth, desire to drink in small sips (not gulping)	Yin Deficiency with Empty Heat

Quick Recall: bleeding has three root mechanisms — too much Heat pushing Blood out, too much tension/pressure forcing it out, or a Deficiency that fails to hold it in. Ask which one before treating the bleeding itself.

Table 24.1 — Factors Affecting Pain (Empty/Full/Cold/Heat)

Factor	Empty	Full	Cold	Heat
Food	Alleviated	Aggravated	—	—
Character	Lingering ache	Sharp	Cramping	Burning
Temperature	—	—	Alleviated by heat	Alleviated by cold
Bowel movement	Alleviated	Aggravated	Alleviated	Aggravated
Pressure	Better lying down	Better sitting up	—	—
Vomiting	Alleviated	Aggravated	Alleviated	Aggravated
Rest/movement	Better with rest	Better with movement	Better with movement	Worse with movement

Table 24.2 — Causes of Pain by Location

Cause	Organs Affected	Locations
Qi stagnation	Liver, Stomach, Intestines	Epigastrium, abdomen
Blood stasis	Liver, Uterus, Heart, Stomach, Intestines	Head, chest, epigastrium, abdomen, Uterus
Liver-Yang rising	Liver	Head
Retention of food	Stomach, Intestines	Epigastrium, abdomen
Cold	Stomach, Uterus, Intestines	Epigastrium, Uterus, abdomen, joints
Damp-Heat	Stomach, Uterus, Intestines, Bladder, Gall Bladder	Hypochondrium, epigastrium, abdomen, hypogastrium, joints
External Wind	—	Whole body, joints
External Dampness	Stomach, Intestines, Uterus	Head, epigastrium, abdomen, Uterus, joints
Phlegm	Stomach, Intestines, Uterus	Head, epigastrium, abdomen, joints

Su Wen 39 — Mechanisms of Pain (Nourishment Focus)

Presentation	Mechanism
Cold outside conduit	Blood diminished, Qi cannot pass
Relieved with pressure	Cold Qi guests between Stomach and Intestine; Blood/Qi dispersed upon compression
Palpation doesn't help	Cold Qi guests deep-lying along the spine; cannot be reached by compression
Referred pain in heart region, loss of consciousness	Cold Qi guests in the Back-Shu conduit draining into the Heart
Radiates to genitals/back	Cold Qi guests in Jueyin, wraps around genitals and links to Liver
Abdominal pain to thigh/buttock	Cold reaches underbelly, hesitant blood flow

2) Food & Taste

Topic	Finding	Pattern
General rule	Relieved by eating	Empty condition
General rule	Aggravated by eating	Full condition
Vomiting	Sour	Liver invading Stomach
Vomiting	Bitter	Liver and/or Gallbladder Heat
Vomiting	Clear, watery	Cold in Stomach
Vomiting	Soon after eating	Heat in Stomach
Vomiting	Sudden, forceful	Full Condition
Vomiting	Slow, weak	Empty Condition

3) Stools & Urine — Expanded

Finding	Pattern
Difficult BM, stools not dry	Liver-Qi stagnation
Constipation + abdominal pain	Internal Cold (Full or Empty)
Constipation, dry stool, small sips of fluid	Yin deficiency (Kidney/Stomach)
Desire but inability to pass stool	Central Qi (Stomach/Spleen) deficiency with sinking Spleen-Qi
Alternating constipation/diarrhea	Stagnant Liver-Qi invading Spleen
Chronic diarrhea, very early morning	Kidney-Yang deficiency ("cock's crow diarrhea")
Diarrhea + abdominal pain	Interior Cold in the Intestines
Diarrhea with mucus	Dampness in Intestines
Diarrhea with blood/ mucus	Damp-Heat in Intestines
Black/very dark stools	Blood stasis
Blood first, bright red, splashing	Heat in the Blood
Blood first, turbid, heavy/painful anus	Damp-Heat in Intestines
Stool first then watery blood	Spleen-Qi deficient, unable to hold Blood
Foul-smelling stools	Heat
Absence of smell	Cold
Borborygmus + loose stools	Spleen deficiency
Borborygmus + distention, no loose stools	Liver-Qi stagnation
Flatulence, foul smell	Damp-Heat or retention of food
Flatulence, no smell	Interior Cold from Spleen-Yang deficiency
Enuresis/incontinence	Kidney deficiency
Retention of urine	Dampness in Bladder (occasionally Lung-Qi deficiency)
Pain before/during/ after urination	Before=Qi stagnation Lower Burner; during=Damp-Heat Bladder; after=Qi Deficiency
Very frequent, copious urination	Kidney-Yang deficiency
Frequent, scanty urination	Qi deficiency
Scanty, dark urine	Kidney-Yin deficiency

4) Thirst & Drink

Finding	Pattern
Desire for cold drinks	Heat
Desire for warm liquids	Cold
Absence of thirst	Cold, or no Heat present
Thirst with no desire to drink	Damp-Heat or Yin deficiency

5) Energy Level — Tiredness Sub-Patterns

Presentation	Pattern
Chronic tiredness, feeling cold	Kidney-Yang deficiency
Chronic tiredness, dizziness, blurred vision, scanty periods	Liver-Blood deficiency
Chronic tiredness, malar flush, red tongue no coating	Kidney-Yin deficiency
Chronic tiredness, heaviness	Dampness
Chronic tiredness, muzy head, dizziness	Phlegm
Chronic tiredness, distention, irritability, Wiry pulse	Liver-Qi stagnation
Short bouts, hot/cold sensation, irritability, alternating	Lesser Yang (Shao Yang) pattern

6) Head, Face & Body — Expanded

Headache Onset/ Timing	Pattern
Recent, short duration	Exterior Wind-Cold attack
Gradual, in attacks	Interior type
Daytime	Qi or Yang deficiency
Evening	Blood or Yin deficiency
Night-time	Blood stasis
Headache Quality	Pattern
Empty, dull, back of brain to neck	Kidney deficiency
Distending, throbbing	Liver-Yang rising
Boring, nail-like point	Blood stasis
Muzziness and heaviness	Dampness
Muzziness, heaviness, dizziness	Phlegm
Aggravated by cold/ heat/fatigue/emotion/ sex	Cold/Heat/Qi def/Liver-Yang/Kidney deficiency respectively

Dizziness	Pattern	
Severe, loses balance	Internal Wind, Liver–Yang rising	
Feeling of emptiness	—	
Slight, worse when tired	Blood deficiency	
Sudden vs gradual onset	Full vs Empty pattern	
Face	Finding	Pattern
Facial pain, acute, heat sensation	—	Invasion of Wind–Heat
Facial pain, spastic, sneezing, aversion to cold	—	Invasion of Wind–Cold
Facial pain, chronic	—	Qi deficiency and Blood stasis in the channel
Runny nose	Clear, thin	Wind–Cold
Runny nose	Thick, sticky, yellow	Wind–Heat or Damp–Heat in Stomach
Bleeding gums	+ tiredness, poor appetite, loose stool	Deficient Spleen–Qi not holding Blood
Bleeding gums	+ inflamed, heat, thirst	Stomach Full–Heat
Bleeding gums	+ dizziness, tinnitus, night sweat, malar flush	Kidney–Yin deficiency with Empty–Heat
Mouth ulcers	Inside cheeks	Stomach–Heat
Mouth ulcers	Red-rimmed on gums	Stomach Full–Heat
Mouth ulcers	Pale-rimmed on gums	Stomach Empty–Heat
Mouth ulcers	Tip of tongue	Heart–Fire or Heart Empty–Heat
Cold sores	Sudden, burning	Stomach Heat
Cold sores	Recurring for years	Stomach Empty–Heat
Cold sores	Pale, aggravated by overwork	Qi deficiency
Body	Finding	Pattern
Whole body pain	Sudden, aversion to cold, fever	Exterior Wind invasion
Whole body pain	Ache + tiredness	Qi–Blood deficiency
Postpartum body pain	Dull vs severe	Blood deficiency vs Blood stasis
Back pain	Continuous, dull, better with rest	Kidney deficiency
Back pain	Recent, severe, stabbing	Blood stasis
Back pain	Worse cold/damp, better with heat	Invasion of exterior Cold–Damp
Numbness, bilateral	—	Blood deficiency
Numbness, unilateral (esp. first 3 fingers)	—	Internal Wind and Phlegm (possible impending Wind–stroke)

7) Chest & Abdomen

Region	Finding	Pattern
Chest	Stabbing pain	Heart Blood Stasis
Chest	Pain + cough + yellow sputum	Phlegm-Heat in the Lungs
Chest	Oppression	Phlegm obstructing Lungs, or Liver-Qi stagnation
Hypochondrium	Distention	Liver-Qi stagnation
Hypochondrium	Stabbing	Blood stasis
Epigastrium	Dull, alleviated by eating	Empty/Deficiency
Epigastrium	Severe, aggravated by eating	Full/Excess (food retention, Stomach Heat/Fire, Phlegm-Fire, Blood stasis, Liver-Qi invading)
Epigastrium	Fullness/heaviness	Dampness
Lower abdomen	Relieved by BM	Full Condition
Lower abdomen	Aggravated by BM	Empty Condition
Hypogastrium	Pain	Damp-Heat in the Bladder

8) Limbs — Expanded

Finding	Pattern
Bi Syndrome, generalized joint pain	Wind (often combined w/ Cold/Damp/Heat)
Wandering, shifting, aching	Wind
Severe, fixed, worse w/ cold	Cold
Heavy aching, immobile joints	Dampness
Redness, swelling, heaviness	Heat
Tingling sensation	Blood deficiency
Numbness, unilateral	Wind or Wind-Phlegm
Heaviness/numbness in joints	Dampness
Atrophy/flaccidity, early stage	Stomach and Spleen-Qi deficiency
Atrophy/flaccidity, later stage	Liver/Kidney Yin deficiency or Spleen/Kidney Yang deficiency
Tremor	Always Liver-Wind (Excess or Deficiency type)
Cold hands + palpitations/dizziness	Heart Blood deficiency
Cold fingers/toes	Liver-Qi stagnation
Cold feet, women	Liver-Blood deficiency
Weak knees	Kidney deficiency (esp. Kidney-Yang)
Feeling of heaviness	Dampness (± Heat/Cold); if in all 4 limbs w/ Stomach-Qi def too = combined Spleen/Stomach Qi deficiency

9) Sleep — Expanded

Finding	Pattern
Sleepy after eating	Spleen-Qi deficiency
General lethargy, heaviness of body	Retention of Dampness
Extreme lethargy + feeling cold	Kidney-Yang deficiency
Lethargic stupor, rattling throat, slippery pulse	Phlegm misting the Mind
Can't fall/stay asleep	Blood deficiency not anchoring Shen/Hun (Empty)
Restless, heat, excessive dreaming	Pathogens agitating Shen/Hun out of Blood (Full)
Difficulty falling asleep	Blood deficiency (usually Heart, can be Liver/Spleen)
Waking many times at night	Yin deficiency with Empty Heat (Heart, Liver, or Kidney)
Waking early, can't return to sleep	Gall Bladder deficiency
Insomnia + night sweats + palpitations + dreams	Heart and Kidney Yin deficiency with Empty-Heat
Dream-disturbed sleep	Liver-Fire or Heart-Fire
Restless sleep, excessive dreams	Retention of food

Not tested: the Categories of Dreams material (Zhuangzi's butterfly, Po/Hun/Shen dream types, Su Wen 17 & 80, Ling Shu 43 dream-by-organ correspondences) is explicitly marked "Bonus Material, Will Not Be Tested."

10) Sweating

Category	Detail
Full conditions	Often due to Heat or Damp-Heat
Empty conditions	Often due to Yang deficiency or Yin deficiency

Area	Pattern
Head only	Heat in Stomach, or Damp-Heat; if profuse/critical = Collapse of Yang
Arms and legs only	Stomach and Spleen deficiency
Whole body	Lung-Qi deficiency
Palms, soles, chest	Yin deficiency (five-palm heat)
Daytime	Yang deficiency
Night-time	Yin deficiency (occasionally Damp-Heat)
Profuse cold sweat, severe illness	Collapse of Yang
Oily sweat on forehead like pearls	Collapse of Yang — danger of imminent death
Oily sweat quality	Severe Yang deficiency
Yellow sweat	Damp-Heat

11) Ears & Eyes

Finding	Pattern
Tinnitus, sudden onset	Full condition — Liver-Fire, Liver-Yang rising, Liver-Wind
Tinnitus, gradual onset	Empty condition — Kidney deficiency
Tinnitus, worse with pressure on ears	Full condition
Tinnitus, better with pressure on ears	Empty condition
Tinnitus, loud/high-pitched like a whistle	Liver-Yang, Liver-Fire, or Liver-Wind
Tinnitus, low-pitched like rushing water	Kidney deficiency
Deafness, sudden	Full condition — Liver-Fire/Yang/Wind
Deafness, gradual	Empty — Kidney deficiency, Heart-Blood or Qi of Upper Burner
Eye pain, swelling, redness	Invasion of Wind-Heat or Liver-Fire
Eye feeling of pressure	Kidney-Yin deficiency
Blurred vision + floaters	Liver-Blood, Liver-Yin, or Kidney-Yin deficiency
Blurred vision + photophobia	Liver-Blood deficiency or Liver-Yang rising
Dry eyes	Liver and/or Kidney Yin deficiency

12) Cold, Heat & Fever

Pattern	Corresponds To
Simultaneous aversion to cold + fever	Tai Yang stage (Six Stages) / Wei Level (Four Levels) — the key sign of Exterior invasion
Feeling of heat, no aversion to cold	Pathogen has entered the Interior
Alternating cold and heat	Shao Yang stage (GB/TH, Six Stages) / Gallbladder Heat at Qi Level (Four Levels)

Fever intensity reflects the STRUGGLE between Zheng Qi (Upright Qi) and the pathogen, not which pathogen it is: both strong = high fever; both weak = low fever; Zheng Qi weaker than pathogen = medium fever.

Feeling of Cold	Pattern
Cold limbs and abdomen	Spleen-Yang/Stomach-Yang deficiency
Cold hands/feet, esp. fingers	Liver-Qi stagnation
Cold hands and chest	Heart-Blood deficiency or Yang deficiency
Cold feet	Kidney-Yang deficiency or Liver-Qi stagnation
Cold legs/knees/feet/back	Kidney-Yang deficiency

Feeling of Heat	Pattern
Heat in afternoon/evening	Empty-Heat (Yin deficiency)
Low-grade fever, constant	Damp-Heat
Fever in the middle of the night	Yin deficiency

13) Emotional Symptoms

Depression Type	Pattern
+ insomnia, palpitations, weak limbs, loose stool	Spleen and Heart-Blood deficiency (Empty)
+ palpitations, cold hands	Heart-Yang deficiency (Empty)
+ moodiness, irritability	Liver-Qi stagnation (Full)
+ irritability, red tongue	Stagnant Liver-Qi turning into Heat (Full)
+ lump in throat sensation, swollen tongue	Phlegm-Fire harassing the Mind (Full)
+ palpitations, agitation, purple tongue	Heart Blood Stasis (Full)

Anxiety Type	Pattern
+ insomnia, palpitations	Heart-Blood deficiency
+ timidity, Heart/GB involvement	Heart and Gall Bladder Qi deficiency
+ hypochondrial distention	Liver-Qi Stagnation (Full)
+ headache at temples, tinnitus, dizziness	Liver-Yang rising (Full)
+ red eyes, bitter taste, dark urine	Liver-Fire (Full)
+ manic behavior, swollen tongue	Phlegm-Fire Harassing the Mind (Full)

Other Emotion	Associated Patterns
Irritability/Anger	Qi stagnation, Blood stasis, Liver-Yang rising, Blood deficiency, Yin deficiency, Heat/Damp-Heat
Worry/Overthinking	Heart and Spleen Qi deficiency, Lung-Qi deficiency, Heart-Blood deficiency, Liver-Blood deficiency, Heart-Yin deficiency with Empty-Heat
Sadness/Grief	Lung and Heart Qi deficiency, Liver-Blood deficiency, Heart-Blood deficiency

14) Sexual Symptoms

Men	Pattern
Impotence + cold, backache, clear urine	Kidney-Yang Deficiency
Impotence + dizziness, palpitations, choppy pulse	Heart-Blood Deficiency
Impotence + tiredness/ dizziness after ejaculation, rapid pulse	Heart-Fire
Impotence + scrotal heaviness, discharge, sticky-yellow coat	Damp-Heat in the Liver channel
Premature ejaculation	Kidney Yang/Qi deficiency, Kidney-Qi not firm, Spleen deficiency, Heart-Qi/Blood deficiency, Lung deficiency
Tiredness/dizziness after ejaculation	Liver-Qi stagnation, or Kidney deficiency

Women	Pattern
Lack of libido/ anorgasmia	Kidney or Heart deficiency, Kidney-Yang deficiency
Excessive desire	Liver or Heart-Fire, Empty-Heat from Kidney-Yin deficiency
Headache after orgasm	Rebellious Qi of the Chong Mai, or Heart-Fire

15) Women's Health

Aspect	Finding	Pattern
Cycle	Always early	Blood-Heat or Qi deficiency
Cycle	Always late	Blood deficiency, Blood stagnation, or Cold
Cycle	Irregular	Liver-Qi stagnation or Liver/Spleen deficiency
Amount	Profuse	Blood-Heat or Qi deficiency
Amount	Scanty	Blood deficiency, Blood stagnation, or Cold
Color	Pale/light-red	Blood-Heat (bright) or Blood deficiency (pale)
Color	Purple/blackish	Blood or Cold stasis
Color	Fresh red	Empty-Heat from Yin deficiency
Quality	Congeaed with clots	Stasis of Blood or Cold
Quality	Watery	Blood or Yin deficiency
Quality	Turbid	Blood-Heat or Cold stagnation
Pain timing	Before period	Stagnation of Qi or Blood
Pain timing	During period	Blood-Heat or Cold stagnation
Pain timing	After period	Blood deficiency
Leukorrhea	White, thin, watery	Spleen-Yang or Kidney-Yang deficiency
Leukorrhea	Greenish-yellow	Damp-Heat in Liver channel
Leukorrhea	Watery	Cold-Damp
Leukorrhea	Thick/sticky	Damp-Heat
Infertility	—	Blood/Kidney-Essence deficiency, Damp-Phlegm in Lower Burner, Blood stasis in Uterus, or Cold in Uterus
Miscarriage, before 3 months	—	Blood or Essence deficiency
Miscarriage, after 3 months	—	Liver-Blood stasis or sinking Spleen-Qi
Postpartum: nausea + heavy bleeding	—	Exhaustion of the Chong Mai
Postpartum: sweating + fever	—	Exhaustion of Qi and Blood
Postpartum depression	—	Heart-Blood deficiency

16) Children's Health

Finding	Pattern
Abdominal pain	Cold in Stomach/Intestines, or Qi stagnation
Vomiting milk, colic (babies)	Retention of food
Cough, wheezing, earache	Wind attacking the Lungs
Chronic cough, sticky sputum	Damp-Phlegm in Lungs
Skin rash, insomnia, character change	Latent Heat
Chronic earache	Damp-Heat in Gall Bladder channel
Disturbed sleep + crying (babies)	Retention of food or Stomach-Heat
Disturbed sleep (older children)	Liver-Fire or Stomach-Heat

7 • Week 8 — Diagnosis by Palpation 切診 (non-pulse)

Schrier frames palpation as giving you access to information the other three pillars can't: the state of the channels themselves, trigger points, adhesions, and structural findings you simply cannot see or ask about. His teaching method for this unit is heavily hands-on — students spend much of the class actually palpating each other's forearms, lower legs, and abdomens rather than only reviewing slides.

Channel Palpation — the Beaver Dam and the Gummy Bear

Schrier compares an obstructed channel to a beaver dam: Qi backs up behind the blockage, and when you release it (needling the point), the pent-up flow can come through forcefully enough that a patient feels a jolt somewhere distant — the classic experience of needling the arm and feeling it in the opposite-side toe, following the paired six-conformation relationships. For nodules found along a channel, his practical texture test is gummy bears: is it soft and squishy (fresher, more moist) or hard and stale, like a gummy bear left out of the package on the counter too long? That texture distinction maps onto Phlegm (softer) versus Blood Stasis or Cold (harder, more congealed).

Technique	Method	Finding → Meaning
Channel tracing	Palpate forearm (wrist→elbow) and lower leg (ankle→knee) three times, pressing progressively deeper each pass — light, medium, deep (Heaven, Earth, Humanity)	Structural changes, muscle tension, nodules, lumpiness along the pathway
Pressing (Ashi)	Thumb/fingertip pressure along the channel and at points	Tenderness/pain = Excess. Feels good under pressure = still some stagnation, but with an underlying Deficiency component — "the more it feels good, the more something's stuck that wants to move." Slippery or hard = Phlegm.
Feeling	Temperature, moisture, skin texture	Rough (like a cat's tongue or lizard skin), sticky/gummy, or the presence of rashes along a channel's course all localize to that channel's associated organ or region

Quick Recall: palpate moving upward along the direction of the Five Transport (Wu Shu) points — from fingers/toes toward elbows/knees — not downward; this is a diagnostic convention distinct from Qigong energy work, which can move either direction.

Skin Temperature — Why the Back of the Hand Goes First

Schrier's practical tip: check temperature with the back of your hand before the palm, because the back of the hand runs cooler and gives you a more accurate baseline reading rather than one skewed by your own palm's warmth. He also cautions that clothing and room temperature can distort the reading — a patient wearing a heavy sweatshirt on one side of the body, or sitting in a cold exam room, can present a temperature difference that has nothing to do with their underlying pattern. Always account for the room and the layers before concluding anything.

Presentation	Pattern
Cold	Cold pattern
Hot on 1st touch, cools w/ sustained pressure	Exterior Wind-Heat, still only at the Wei (exterior) level
Hot over the blood vessel on medium pressure, not heavy	Interior Heat in the Middle Burner/Heart
Hot on heavy pressure, nearly reaching the bone	Empty-Heat from Yin Deficiency — the extreme form of this is "steaming bone disorder," where heat feels like it's radiating from the bone itself
Hot dorsal (back of hand)	Full Heat (Ling Shu 74)
Hot palm	Empty Heat (Ling Shu 74)

Hands and Feet

Finding	Pattern
Cold hands and feet, warm torso	Liver Qi Stagnation — the Liver isn't ensuring smooth Qi flow to the extremities, so warmth stays trapped centrally
Cold hands	Lung and/or Heart Yang Deficiency
Cold feet	Kidney (Yang) Deficiency
Cold feet, in women specifically	Liver Blood Deficiency
Cold fingers and toes	Liver Qi Stagnation

Xu Li (Apical Beat) — The Pool Ladder Test

The apical beat is the pulse of the heart/left ventricle, felt at the fifth intercostal space. Schrier's analogy for the region just below the xiphoid process (reflecting the Upper Burner and Zong Qi): a set of pool ladder steps. If you press your thumb straight through a worn stair tread with no resistance, that structure has failed — too soft, too giving, which maps to Deficiency. A healthy structure has just enough give without being rigid — too hard and unyielding maps to Full/stagnation.

Presentation	Pattern
Clear/slow	Normal
Feeble	Zong Qi deficiency
Strong/hard	Excess Lung/Heart
Large but empty	Heart-Qi deficiency
Stop-start	Severe shock or alcoholism; poor prognosis if discrepant from the radial pulse
Rapid	Shock, fright, or sudden anger

Abdominal & Point Palpation

Schrier traces the abdominal map to the same cosmological Five-Phase layout used for the face and pulse, but notes it wasn't fully developed until Japanese practitioners — particularly the blind acupuncturist Waichi Sugiyama — extended the foundational work found in the Nan Jing and Shang Han Lun. Sugiyama is also credited (per the story Schrier tells, acknowledging it's more legend than verified fact) with inventing the guide tube after a fall down a ravine left a pine needle wrapped in a leaf pressed against his skin — giving him the idea for a way to insert needles with far less pain than his own famously rough technique. Practical courtesy point: never palpate straight down a patient's abdomen from the pubic bone without warning — ask them to place their own hand at the top of the pubic bone (CV3) as a landmark, and work from CV17 downward to the umbilicus, and from CV3 upward to the umbilicus, rather than palpating across that boundary directly.

Topic	Detail
Nan Jing 5-Phase map	Above navel (Ren 12–15)=Heart/Fire · at navel=Spleen/Earth · below navel (Ren 7–Pubis)=Kidney/Water · R side under ribs=Lung/Metal · L side under ribs=Liver/Wood
Normal abdomen	Solid-not-hard, resilient-not-tight, elastic-not-soft (the "pool ladder" test). Hard+pain worse w/ pressure=Full. Too-soft+ache relieved=Empty. Fixed masses=Blood stasis.
Palpating lumps (channel, breast-adjacent, abdominal)	Soft=Phlegm · Hard=Blood Stasis or Cold congealing · Distinct edges=Phlegm · Indistinct edges=Toxic Heat · Mobile=Phlegm-Damp · Immobile=Blood Stasis or Toxic Heat
Front-Mu vs Back-Shu	Front-Mu (alarm points) = where Qi of the organs collects/accumulates, more associated with treating Excess. Back-Shu = stronger Qi reserve, often better for Deficiency, though also used to clear Excess.
Front-Mu numbering mnemonic	Higher rib-cage points correspond to upper-body organs and lower-numbered points near the sternum/chest; a quick way to sanity-check a Back-Shu point's location is that lower numbers (BL 13) sit higher on the back (Lung) and higher numbers (BL 28) sit lower (Bladder) — upper, middle, and lower Burner order top to bottom.

Aggressive Energy (Worsley system): a non-classical addition Schrier includes because some students will encounter it in Five Element/Worsley-influenced clinics. AE is described as toxic Qi circulating through the Ke (control) cycle; under the fingertip it reportedly feels like the buzzing vibration of an electric razor at specific Back-Shu points (BL 13, 14, 15, 18, 20, 23). Diagnosis is confirmed only through the treatment itself — needling the point plus a nearby "test needle" and watching for erythema (redness) that lingers around the main needle longer than around the test needle. This is not on the national boards; it's included as clinical color for those who go on to study Five Element/Worsley-style acupuncture.

Palpating the Chest

Finding	Pattern
Tender at CV17 with light palpation	Heart Blood Stasis (or, depending on location, Lung Excess)
Tenderness relieved by light palpation	Deficiency
Tenderness relieved by light palpation but elicited by deeper palpation	Mixed Deficiency and Excess
Tenderness increases with deeper palpation	Excess

Palpating the Three Jiao (Burners)

The goal isn't necessarily to find "normal" (evenly warm) — Schrier's clinical preference is actually for a uniform temperature across all three Burners, even if that uniform temperature is cold or hot throughout, over a lopsided picture (e.g., a very cold Lower Burner beneath a hot Middle and Upper Burner). A uniform imbalance is, paradoxically, more internally consistent and often more straightforward to treat than a split thermostat within the same body.

Burner	Location	Contains
Upper	Above the diaphragm	Heart, Pericardium, Lungs
Middle	Between diaphragm and navel	Stomach, Spleen, Liver, Gallbladder
Lower	Below the navel	Small Intestine, Large Intestine, Bladder, Kidney

Channel Palpation in the Classics

Concept
Involves tracing the pathways of the 12 primary channels to determine the quality of Qi and Blood flow. Discussed in: Huang Di Nei Jing (Su Wen 20; Ling Shu 20, 51, 73, 75), Nan Jing 13, Zhang Zhongjing's Shang Han Lun, Sun Simiao's Qian Jin Yao Fang, Li Shizhen's Qijing Ba Mai Kao.
What Palpation Can Tell Us
Stagnations (local or generalized) · Ashi/trigger points · Channel involvement · Severity of condition · Organ/ligament health, flexibility, location · Adhesions/obstructions (stagnation, blockage, dampness)

Skin Moisture & Texture

Finding	Indication
Moist skin	Invasion of exterior Wind
Moist, no exterior symptoms	Lung-Qi deficiency
Dry skin	Blood deficiency or Yin deficiency
Rough skin	Bi Zheng/Painful Obstruction Syndrome from Wind
Scaly and dry skin	Exhaustion of Body Fluids or severe Liver-Blood deficiency
Swollen, pitting	"Water swelling" — Spleen and/or Kidney Yang deficiency
Swollen, non-pitting	"Qi swelling" — Dampness or Qi stagnation

8 · Week 9 — Diagnosis by Hearing & Smelling 聞診

Wén Zhén is the second of the Four Diagnostic Methods (望聞問切) and has two distinct components sharing one character (聞 — "to perceive with the ear/nose"). Schrier is explicit about what you're actually doing with the smelling component in practice: you are not smelling a patient's urine, stool, sputum, or vaginal discharge. You ask them what these things smell like, since they have direct access to that information and you generally don't (sweat and breath being the practical exceptions you might notice directly in the room).

Component	Covers
Hearing	Voice, breathing, cough, vomiting, hiccup, borborygmi, sighing, belching — any sound emitted by the patient
Smelling	Body odor, and odor of bodily secretions (breath, sweat, sputum, urine/stools, vaginal discharge, intestinal gas)

Voice & Zang-Fu Relationship

Schrier separates the voice's production from its volume: the Lung is the gateway of the voice, moving Qi to create sound in the first place, while the Kidney is the root of the voice, controlling volume because it's the root of Yuan Qi and governs the Qi's reception once the Lung sends it down. He offers a "Jimmy" story to illustrate Wood/shouting-style assertiveness: a substitute teacher, trying to get his attention, kept calling him by the wrong name ("Jimmy") with increasing frustration, eventually smacking the desk to demand a response — assertive, forceful, attention-demanding, without necessarily being angry. That forcefulness (not necessarily volume alone) is the signature of the Wood/Shouting sound.

Organ	Role	Governs
Lung	Gateway of the voice; movement of Qi helps create sounds	Production of sound
Kidney	Root of the voice; root of Yuan Qi	Volume of the voice
Spleen/Stomach	Acquired root of Qi	Strength of the voice

Voice, Breathing & Reflexive Sound Patterns

Schrier tells a story about his cat, nicknamed "Darth Vader" for her labored, raspy breathing, caused (it turned out, after years of tests) by a large nasal polyp; once it was surgically removed, the sound disappeared entirely. The point for clinical practice: an abnormal respiratory sound is real diagnostic data even when its cause isn't obvious right away, and structural causes should stay on the differential alongside pattern-based ones.

Presentation	Pattern
Loud voice	Full or Heat pattern — think of how your own voice sounds when you're truly angry and trying to make someone stop: forceful, loud, hot
Weak voice	Empty or Cold pattern
Reluctance to talk	Cold pattern or Lung-Qi deficiency — Cold slows everything down, including the will to speak
Excessive talking	Heat — Schrier's example: children as "little hot buckets," constantly narrating everything ("did you know I can stand on my toes?"); adults who talk excessively often report feeling warm or overheated while doing it
Sudden loss of voice	Invasion of Wind-Heat
Gradual loss of voice	Lung-Qi or Lung-Yin deficiency
Coarse, loud breathing	Full pattern
Weak, thin breathing	Empty pattern
Loud, explosive cough	Full pattern
Weak cough	Empty pattern
Borborygmi (stomach gurgling)	Loud=Full; low/weak=Empty (Spleen/Kidney Yang deficiency)

Five Element Sounds — With Cultural Illustrations

Schrier uses broad, explicitly non-judgmental cultural comparisons to make these sounds memorable: he describes German speech patterns as leaning Wood/assertive (direct, forceful, even in affectionate expressions), Welsh speech as carrying a Fire-like rising-and-falling melodic quality, and Japanese cultural precision (tea ceremony, sword forms, bento box arrangement) as exemplifying Metal's clean, exact, single-motion perfection. These are teaching illustrations of the sound-quality associations, not clinical claims about any individual patient's constitution.

Sound	Element	Quality
Shouting	Wood	Forceful, attention-demanding, assertive (not necessarily angry)
Laughing	Fire	Outward, bursting expression — including the "pre-laugh" giggle a child gives before they even finish telling a joke
Singing	Earth	Soothing, nurturing, rises and falls gently — the voice you use calming a child or an anxious animal
Weeping	Metal	Consumes/dissolves Qi; a voice on the verge of tears, choking back words
Groaning	Water	Flat, stretched, little modulation — like a VHS tape played back slowed down

Diagnosis by Smelling

Odor	Description / Indication
Rancid/Sour	Fat no longer fresh; also smell of newly-mown grass; prickling effect on the nose
Scorched	Burnt toast, clothes from the dryer, a scorched shirt while ironing
Fragrant	Related to pleasant smells like flowers, but not as pleasing — cloying, sickly sweet, tends to linger
Rotten	Rotting meat; fills the nose with tiny prickles
Putrid	Similar to rotting meat but sharper/more aggressive; smell of stagnant water

Schrier's distinction for a true Cold-Damp "fishy" odor: not the aggressive smell of a Chinatown fish market, but the very light, mild, faintly salty smell of a freshly caught fish held up and sniffed directly — subtle, not pungent. Strong, intense odor generally points toward Heat/Excess; faint or absent odor toward Cold/Deficiency. He repeats the gravy-thickening-on-the-stove image from earlier weeks for the consistency of vaginal discharge/leucorrhea: watery (thin, like gravy mix fresh in cold water) points to Cold/Deficiency, while thick and sticky (like gravy reduced too long on the heat) points to Heat/Damp.

Secretion	Finding	Pattern
Breath	Strong, foul	Stomach Heat or retention of food
Sweat	Putrid-smelling	Damp-Heat
Sputum	Strong-smelling, rotten	Phlegm-Heat or Toxic Heat
Sputum	Fishy-smelling	Lung-Heat
Urine	Heavy smell of urea, scanty yellow	Heart fire pouring into Bladder
Urine	Clear, frequent, odorless	Cold
Vaginal discharge	Strong-smelling, leathery, thick/sticky	Damp-Heat
Vaginal discharge	Fishy smell, thin/watery	Damp-Cold

Flag: the Scorched odor slide uses 笑 (xiào) where the classical character is 焦 (jiāo) — confirm with Prof. Schrier before the final. The Five Named Odors are not explicitly paired to Zang-Fu organs in the source slides.

Borborygmi, Yawning & Sighing — Detail

Sound	Finding	Pattern
Borborygmi	Loud (Full), usually with diarrhea/dysentery	Cold-Damp in Middle Burner, Phlegm-Damp in MB, Liver/Spleen disharmony, or Damp-Heat in Stomach/Intestines
Borborygmi	Low (Empty)	Spleen/Kidney Yang deficiency, Middle Burner Qi deficiency
Yawning	Frequent, loud, relieved after, induced by emotion	Liver-Qi Stagnation
Yawning	+ chest pain, after injury/chronic illness	Blood and Qi Stagnation
Yawning	Infrequent, weak or no sound	Spleen/Kidney Yang Deficiency
Sighing	General	Qi stagnation of the Liver or Lungs, often from emotional causes: repressed anger/frustration (Liver) or worry/sadness (Lungs)
Sighing	Weak sound	Deficiency of Spleen and Heart, deriving from sadness, grief, or pensiveness

Voice — Five Element Sounds, Expanded

Sound	Detail
Singing	Occurs naturally when soothing a child or distressed animal/person; increased pitch variation, goes up and down more frequently
Weeping	Consumes/dissolves Qi; more a non-verbal, emotionally expressive sound; speaking-with-a-weep can turn to crying; may show as choking back or faltering words
Groaning	Little movement or modulation; flat, as if the normal ups and downs of the voice have been squeezed out

Panting, Abnormal Respiration & Cough

Finding	Pattern
Panting, Excess	Irregular respiration, full chest, loud rough sound, uneven exhalation — Xie Qi obstructing the Lung
Panting, Deficiency	Timid breath, low voice, diminished inhalation/increased exhalation, worse with movement — Kidney deficiency (can't absorb Qi) or Lung deficiency (can't govern Qi)
Asthma	Lung-Qi's failure to descend
Wheezing	Lung-Qi fails to descend with Phlegm obstruction
Upper Stifling	Lung-Qi rises upward to the throat, obstructing the air tract
Shortness of breath	Lung-Qi deficiency, or Water Retention in the Chest (coughing watery sputum)
Cough, loud/explosive	Full pattern
Cough, weak	Empty pattern
Cough, dry	Lung-Yin deficiency
Unproductive vs Productive cough	Sound without phlegm = unproductive; phlegm with sound = productive
Sneezing, acute/loud/constant	Heat and/or Excess condition
Sneezing, chronic, soft	Lung-Qi deficiency
Sneezing, sudden in critical illness	Yang-Qi recovery (positive sign)

Vomiting, Hiccup, Belching & Their Differentiation

Finding	Pattern
Vomiting, slow/low/faint/forceless	Deficiency and/or Cold pattern (often Stomach deficiency and Cold)
Vomiting, sudden/loud/forceful	Excess and/or Heat pattern (often Stomach-Heat)
Hiccup, loud	Full pattern, often Liver-Qi invading Stomach
Hiccup, quiet/low	Empty pattern, often Stomach-Qi or Stomach-Yin deficiency
Belching, loud and long	Full — retention of food, Stomach-Heat, or Liver-Qi invading Stomach
Belching, short and low	Deficiency — Stomach-Qi deficiency (± Cold)

Symptom	Mechanism	Distinguishing Feature
Vomiting	Rebellious Stomach-Qi	Food, fluid, or sputum flows up from the Stomach and out of the mouth, with sound
Belching	Rebellious Stomach-Qi	Air/gas flows up from the stomach, makes sound passing through the throat
Hiccup	Rebellious Stomach-Qi	Involuntary diaphragm spasms causing a short sound

Body Odor & Five-Element Odor Detection

Odor	Pattern
Goatish	Wind, Dampness, Heat accumulation
Foul stinking	Epidemic infectious disease, or Summer-Heat toxin
Foul in the armpit	Damp-Heat accumulation

Five-Element odors typically appear only when the patient undresses, especially detectable on the back. Body odors reflect the patient's actual pattern, which may not match their constitutional Element type.

Odor of Secretions — Full Reference

Secretion	Finding	Pattern
Breath	Strong, foul	Stomach Heat or retention of food
Breath	Sour	Retention of food, Accumulation Disorder
Breath	Foul, pungent	Damp-Heat in Stomach and Spleen
Breath	Rotten	Damp-Heat in Large Intestine
Breath	Fishy	Phlegm-Heat in Lung
Sweat	Strong-smelling	Damp-Heat
Sweat	Putrid-smelling	Disease of the Lungs, Liver, or Kidneys
Sputum	Strong, rotten	Heat in Lungs, usually Phlegm-Heat or Toxic Heat
Sputum	Fishy	Lung-Heat
Sputum	Odorless	Cold
Stool	Extremely stinky + pus/blood + flatulence	Damp-Heat in the Intestines
Stool	Sour, foul, with indigestion	Food stagnation
Stool	Fishy with loose stools	Cold in Spleen/Stomach
Flatulence	Slight/odorless, worse with stress	Liver-Qi stagnation
Flatulence	Rancid, rotten (rotten eggs)	Toxic Heat in Large Intestine
Stool/flatulence	Abnormal color, no/weak odor	Stomach/Large Intestine Qi deficiency
Urine	Frequent, urgent, painful, burning, turbid yellow	Damp-Heat in Bladder
Urine	Heavy urea smell, scanty yellow	Heart-Fire pouring into Bladder
Urine	Clear, frequent, odorless or slightly fishy	Kidney deficiency
Urine	Odorless incontinence	Exhaustion of Kidney-Fire
Vaginal discharge	Strong, leathery	Damp-Heat
Vaginal discharge	Fishy	Damp-Cold
Lochia (postpartum)	Strong smelling	Damp-Heat or Toxic Heat in the Uterus
Nose discharge	Yellow, sticky, foul	Heat in Lung, or Damp-Heat in Spleen/Stomach
Ear discharge	Foul, fishy, turbid pus	Damp-Heat in the ear
Eyes	Red, swollen, turbid tears, foul/fishy odor	Damp-Heat in the Liver channel